Israel's Genocide in Gaza: An Annotated Bibliography

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Abstract: Israel's genocide in Gaza is the most documented genocide in history. No other genocide can boast over 3 terabytes of high-definition, color video footage taken by thousands of eye-witnesses from almost every angle imaginable, by both victims and perpetrators—all of which are freely available to the public.[2] The genocide in Gaza has also possibly produced more literature in official reports and public statements by relevant scholars in a shorter period than any other genocide. This intense level of documentation is due to a variety of factors, such as information accessibility on the internet and the widespread use of mobile-recording and social media, intense geopolitical interest in Palestine, and the unique circumstances of the long-lasting military occupation of Palestine by Israel.[3]

This annotated bibliography demonstrates the extensive confirmation of the Gaza genocide and introduces the public to essential literature on this subject and its general background. In doing so, it captures and summarizes key publications and serves as a useful reference work. To be more accessible, the bibliography is divided up into four major sections (each with a historical-contextual introduction), entries are in chronological order and weighted with asterisks to indicate their overall importance, annotations are limited to 150-words and are written for non-specialists.

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[2] *Tiktokgenocide.org*, *watermeloncrimes.com/archives, accountabilityarchive.org*, along with *Tracking Israeli Genocide* (https://t.me/TrackingIsraeliGenocide), have together amassed a near-exhaustive public video library of the Gaza genocide. More accessible compilations of the footage have been curated into dozens of documentaries and thematic videos by *Double Down News, Al Jazeera, Middle East Eye, AJ+* and *Eye on Palestine*. Note also, the compilation of sources at israelgenocide.com, law4palestine.org, and gaza23.com. Partial efforts have been made to erase this history. See, for example, TRT World staff, "Meta just erased slain Gaza journalist Aljafarawi from IG. Is it whitewashing Israeli genocide?" *TRT World,* 15 October 2025.

[3] Israeli holocaust scholar Schmuel Lederman, "A Not So Textbook Case of Genocide," *Journal of Genocide Research* (September 2025), 1–12, calls it "the most political genocide we have faced."

1. Introduction

"Tiktok genocide."[4] "The first-ever live-streamed genocide."[5] "The most documented genocide in history." These were some of the descriptions of the Gaza genocide in public discourse throughout 2023-2025. While various superlatives were used to emphasize the destruction, the public was also inundated by an avalanche of misinformation and disinformation, blurring the realities on the ground—whether with regard to what actually happened on October 7, 2023, or the political and economic motives at play[6]—so much that even after two years of televised dismemberment of children, mass burials, and forced famine, the question was still raised, "Isn't it just another Middle-Eastern war?"[7]

The basic facts of the situation, however, indicated that the wholesale destruction of Gaza was not the outcome of ordinary, or even extraordinary, warfare. In fact, it was not even "another genocide." It was rather a *record-breaking* genocide that continues to change the history books, shape the future of international law, and reconfigure geopolitical relationships.[8]

Since October 2023, the IDF in Gaza:

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[4] This refers to the popular social media app TikTok, through which millions learned about Israeli atrocities in Gaza. For this reason and others (i.e., to coerce ByteDance, the majority corporate owner in China, into selling TikTok to achieve full instead of only partial American ownership), Trump banned the app in an executive order. In U.S. Senator Mitt Romney's words, "Some wonder why there was such overwhelming support for us to shut down potentially TikTok or other entities of that nature. If you look at the postings on TikTok and the number of mentions of Palestinians relative to other social media sites, it's overwhelmingly so among TikTok broadcasts. So I'd note that's of real interest, and the President will get the chance to make action in that regard" ("Mitt Romney Reveals Twisted Reason Why Congress Moved to Ban TikTok," *The New Republic,* 6 May 2024). But the ban only lasted for a matter of hours before coming back online on 19 January 2025. With the failure of changing ownership, the strategy of changing management took place when a former member of the IDF was hired in summer of 2025 to moderate. Middle East Eye staff, " TikTok hires ex-Israeli army instructor as new hate speech manager, sparking backlash," *Middle East Eye,* 29 July 2025. In September 2025, Zionist billionaires—including the second richest man on earth and single largest donor to the IDF, Larry Ellison—finally acquired majority ownership with the help of an executive order by President Trump, and began censoring videos relating to AIPAC and Israel.

[5] It is not clear who first used this phrase (which also has many variants, such as "live-broadcast genocide," etc.).

[6] See, for example, Haaretz staff, "'Real Estate Bonanza': Smotrich Says Israel in Talks With U.S. on Dividing Gaza's Land," *Haaretz,* 17 September 2025; Betsy Klein and Irene Nasser, "Trump describes Gaza as a 'big real estate site' as he doubles down on plans to redevelop the enclave," *CNN,* 9 February 2025; Anais Antreasyan, "Gas Finds in the Eastern Mediterranean: Gaza, Israel, and Other Conflicts," *Journal of Palestinian Studies* 42, no. 3 (Spring, 2013); Betsey Piette, "Behind Israel's 'end game' for Gaza: Theft of offshore gas reserves," *International Action Center*, 14 November 2023, https://iacenter.org/2023/11/15/behind-israels-end-game-for-gaza-theft-of-offshore-gas-reserves.

[7] On the role of media bias covering the Gaza genocide, see Tarek Cherkaoui, "Framing the Gaza Conflict: Media Bias, Violence, and the Battle of Narratives," *The Political Economy of Communication* 11, no. 1 (2025): 85-99; Adam Johnson, "A Study Reveals CNN and MSNBC's Glaring Gaza Double Standard," *The Nation,* 14 October 2024; Emma Lucia Llano, "Western Media Manufactured Consent for Israel's Murder of Palestinian Journalists," *FAIR* (Fairness & Accuracy Reporting), 22 August 2025; Ahmad Hamad Karee and Yaseen Mahmood Najm, "A Critical Discourse Analysis of the Biased Role of Western Media in the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict," *The Journal of Language Studies* 8, no. 6 (2024): 200-215; Faras Ghani, "The Sharp Contrast: How Israeli and Western Media Cover the War on Gaza," *Al Jazeera Journalism Review,* 5 March 2025; Noureddine Miladi, "Seeking 'permission to narrate': Debunking the global media reporting of the Israeli War on Gaza and the Palestine exceptionalism," *Journal of Arab & Muslim Media Research* 18, no. 1 (2025): 3-14; Adam Johnson, "Coverage of Gaza War in the New York Times and Other Major Newspapers Heavily Favored Israel, Analysis Shows," *The Intercept,* 9 January 2024; Bisma Bashir, Zameer Ahmed, Sundas Jabeen Mirza, and Aysal Elham, "Media Biasness in Conflict Reporting: A Comparative Study of CNN and Al Jazeera Coverage of Humanitarian Crisis in Gaza," *Inverge Journal of Social Sciences* 4, no. 2 (May 17, 2025): 69–77; Zahid Ibrar and Musa Khan, "Framing and Media Bias in Conflict Reporting: A Comparative Analysis of Al-Jazeera, CNN, and Global Times During the 2023 Palestine-Israel Conflict," *İnterdisipliner Medya Ve İletişim Çalışmaları*, 2, no. 3 (2025): 42-71; Harriet Williamson, "BBC Gives Israeli Deaths 33 Times More Coverage, New Study Reveals," *Novara Media,* 16 June 2025.Cf. Geoff Golberg, "State-Sponsored Platform Manipulation," *Social Forensics*, July 2023, available at socialforensics.com.

[8] Cf. Martin Shaw, "The Genocide That Changed the World," *Journal of Genocide Research* (September 2025), 1-15.

1. Dropped the equivalent of at least six nuclear bombs (80,000-120,000 tons) on one of the densest populations on earth at the time—in a space less than a third the size of London.[9] This constituted the most destructive bombing campaign since WWII,[10] destroying over 70% of all structures[11] and 92% of all housing.[12]
2. Displaced over 90% of the population (multiple times).[13]
3. Killed more journalists than WWI, WWII, and Vietnam combined, and killed more United Nations workers than any other event in United Nations history.[14] The IDF's killing of over 250 journalists in Gaza also made 2024 the deadliest year for journalists ever recorded by the Committee to Protect Journalists (CPJ).[15] They also achieved the second deadliest attack on journalists every recorded.[16]
4. Killed approximately 30-60 children per day on average,[17] who died primarily by bombardment, incineration, burial in debris, starvation, and execution by IDF snipers[18] whether in or outside "safe zones" and "kill zones."[19]

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[9] Some estimates suggest 200,000 tons or 13 nuclear bombs. See TRT staff, "Genocide: Israel killed 20,000 children in Gaza using 200,000 tonnes of explosives," *TRT World,* 5 October 2025.

[10] Paul Rogers, "Gaza bombing 'equivalent to six Hiroshimas' says Bradford world affairs expert," University of Bradford, 16 April 2025, https://www.bradford.ac.uk/news/archive/2025/gaza-bombing-equivalent-to-six-hiroshimas-says-bradford-world-affairs-expert.php; Jon Gambrell, "Satellite photos show the Gaza Strip before and after the devastation of the Israel-Hamas war," *Associated Press,* January 16, 2025; Muhammad Sio, "Israel dropped 100,000 tons of explosives over Gaza, wiped out 2,200 families: Media office," *Anadolu*, 5 July 2025.

[11] Nir Hason, "New Satellite Data Shows: Gaza Devastation Scale Greater Than Estimated, at Least 70 Percent of Buildings Leveled," *Haaretz,* 17 July 2025.

[12] UNRWA, cited in United Nations statement, "Gaza: Destruction of vital lifting gear halts search for thousands buried under rubble," *UN News*, 22 April 2025, https://news.un.org/en/story/2025/04/1162491.

[13] United Nations, "Enough death and destruction': Gazans hope for ceasefire and a better future," *UN News,* 16 January 2025, https://news.un.org/en/story/2025/01/1159101; Doctors Without Borders, "The trauma of repeated displacement in Gaza," *Doctors Without Borders*, 9 July 2024, https://www.doctorswithoutborders.org/latest/trauma-repeated-displacement-gaza; UNRWA, "UNRWA Situation Report #177 on the Humanitarian Crisis in the Gaza Strip and the West Bank, including East Jerusalem," 29 June 2025, https://www.unrwa.org/resources/reports/unrwa-situation-report-177-situation-gaza-strip-and-west-bank-including-east-jerusalem.

[14] United Nations, "Number of aid workers killed in Gaza conflict, highest in UN history: Guterres," *UN News,* 5 Jun 2025, https://news.un.org/en/story/2025/06/1164086; Sharon Zhang, "Israel's Genocide Has Killed More Journalists Than WWI and WWII Combined: Report," *Truthout,* 1 April 2025.

[15] Committee to Protect Journalists, "Journalist casualties in the Israel-Gaza war, updated from October 2023 to October, 2025, https://cpj.org/2023/10/journalist-casualties-in-the-israel-gaza-conflict. Also note Meron Rapoport, "Israel used to lie about killing journalists; now it barely bothers to do so. What happened?" *The Guardian,* 8 September 2025;

[16] This occurred not in Gaza but in Yemen against the Houthis. William Christou, "Israel attack on Yemini newspaper was second deadliest on journalists ever recorded," *The Guardian,* 20 September 2025.

[17] Edouard Beigbeder, "'Unimaginable horrors': more than 50,000 children reportedly killed or injured in the Gaza Strip," *UNICEF*, 27 May 2025, https://www.unicef.org/press-releases/unimaginable-horrors-more-50000-children-reportedly-killed-or-injured-gaza-strip.

[18] Maud Effting and Willem Feenstra, "Wat De Wonden Vertellen," *de Volkskrant,* 13 September 2025; Defense for Children International: Palestine, "Israeli snipers target Palestinian children in Gaza," 7 March 2025, https://www.dci-palestine.org/israeli_snipers_target_palestinian_children_in_gaza; Tracy Smith, "Children of Gaza," *CBS News*, 21 July 2024; James Walker, "Surgeon breaks down describing 'IDF drones shooting children' in Gaza," *The National,* 13 November 2024; Team Zeteo, " 'A Game of Target Practice': Doctors Back from Gaza Share Harrowing stories of Israel's Brutality in Exclusive Town Hall," *Zeteo,* 10 August, 2025; BBC Worldwide Service, "BBC Examines Shooting of Children of Gaza," BBC, 1 August 2025, https://www.bbc.co.uk/programmes/l0057c0y;

[19] BBC Verify, "Gaza 'humanitarian zone' struck almost 100 times since May, BBC Verify finds," BBC, 15 January 2025; James McKenzie, "Israeli soldiers describe clearance of 'kill zone' on Gaza's edge," *Reuters,* 7 April 2025; Al Jazeera Staff, "Inside the aid-seeker 'kill zone' Israel created in Gaza," *Al Jazeera,* 21 July 2025; Nicola Perugini, "Safe zones: Israel's technologies of genocide," *Al Jazeera,* 6 January 2024.

5. Created the "largest cohort of child amputees in modern history."[20] 10 children lost their legs every day on average.[21]
6. Exceeded typical warfare injuries,[22] surpassed the Rwanda genocide in reducing lifespans,[23] and created a record-breaking forced-famine.[24] The UN Special Rapporteur on Food Security noted "What's unique about this [famine] has been the speed…We've never seen 2.2 million civilians made to go hungry within weeks. So we've never seen this degree of hunger used as a weapon so quickly and so completely—ever."[25] Famine specialist Alex de Waal observed that "there is no case since World War II of starvation that is being so minutely designed and controlled."[26]
7. Bombed or damaged over 90% of all hospitals (36)[27] and 100% of all universities (12), going beyond ordinary war crimes into "scholasticide."[28] Many university presidents and professors were killed, including some in targeted assassinations.[29] "The human toll within academic institutions has been considerable: 5,479 students, 261 teachers, and 95 university professors have been killed, while more than 7,800 students and 756 teachers have been injured. As a result of the ongoing conflict, around 625,000 students have been left without access to any form of education for more than 18 months."[30]
8. Destroyed the water and sanitation system so severely that it created a Polio epidemic in the summer of 2024.[31] Seeing potential benefits to Polio and other outbreaks of disease, the former head of Israel's National Security Council, General Giora Eiland, argued that "We must not shy

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[20] Fatma Khaled and Abdel Kareem Hana, "Gaza's child amputees struggle with recovery, especially after Israel's cutoff of aid," *Associated Press,* 25 March 2025.
[21] Save the Children, "GAZA: More than 10 children a day lose a limb in three months of brutal conflict," January 7, 2024, reported in Jessi Yeung, Radina Gigova and Mohammed Tawfeeq, "More than 10 children losing legs in Gaza every day as dire health crisis grows, aid groups say," *CNN,* 7 January 2024.
[22] Omar El-Taji et. al., "Patterns of war related trauma in Gaza during armed conflict: survey study of international healthcare workers.," *BMJ* September 25, 2025:390:e087524.
[23] Roberto De Vogli et. al., "Break the selective silence on the genocide in Gaza," *The Lancet,* 30 July 2025.
[24] IPC, "IPC Alert: Worse Case of Famine Unfolding in the Gaza Strip," 29 July 2025, https://www.ipcinfo.org/fileadmin/user_upload/ipcinfo/docs/IPC_GazaStrip_Alert_July2025.pdf
[25] Michael Fakhri in interview with *Al Jazeera,* 23 January 2024. Transcript available by *Middle East Eye*, January 23, 2024, https://www.middleeasteye.net/live-blog/live-blog-update/israel-using-hunger-weapon-war-against-palestinians-gaza-un-expert.
[26] Interview with *Al Jazeera*, 21 July 2025. Transcript available by Brett Wilkins, "Famine Expert: Israel's Starvation of Gaza Most 'Minutely Designed and Controlled' Since WWII," *Common Dreams,* 22 July 2025, https://www.commondreams.org/news/famine-expert-israel-s-starvation-of-gaza-most-minutely-designed-and-controlled-since-wwii.
[27] World Health Organization, "Health system at breaking point as hostilities further intensify in Gaza, WHO warns," WHO, 22 May 2025, https://www.who.int/news/item/22-05-2025-health-system-at-breaking-point-as-hostilities-further-intensify--who-warns. The IDF attacked the WHO as well, noted in their press release, "WHO operations compromised following attacks on warehouse and facility sheltering staff and families in Deir al Balah, Gaza," 21 July 2025, https://www.who.int/news/item/21-07-2025-who-operations-compromised-following-attacks-on-warehouse-and-facility-sheltering-staff-and-families-in-deir-al-balah.
[28] OHCHR, "UN experts deeply concerned over 'scholasticide' in Gaza," 14 April 2024, https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2024/04/un-experts-deeply-concerned-over-scholasticide-gaza; Henry Giroux, "Scholasticide: Waging War on Education from Gaza to the West," *The Journal of Holy Land Studies* 24, no. 1 (March 26, 2025); Ibrahim, Hiba B., and Savo Heleta, "Scholasticide in Gaza and Palestine As a Portal: A Duoethnography on Silence, Silencing and the Struggle for a Better World," *Journal of Global Higher Education* 1, no. 1 (2025):39-68; Kate May, "Scholasticide in Gaza: A Need for Recognition of Systematic Educational Destruction as Genocidal" *OpinioJuris,* 23 July 2025; César Domínguez, "Scholasticide: Educational Lawfare as a Marker of the End of Civilianness," *Diacritics* 52, no.1 (2024): 120-138.
[29] In addition to references in the previous footnote, see Euro-Med Human Rights Monitor, "Israeli Strike on Refaat al-Areer Apparently Deliberate," 8 December 2023, https://euromedmonitor.org/en/article/6014/Israeli-Strike-on-Refaat-al-Areer-Apparently-Deliberate; Ibtisam Mahdi, "The decimation of Gaza's academia is 'impossible to quantify,'" *+972 Magazine*, 26 July 2024.
[30] Renee Davis, "Israel's war on knowledge: A 'scholasticide' in progress?," *L'Orient Today*, 8 May 2025.
[31] Nada Al-Taher, "Gaza declares polio epidemic 25 years after disease was eradicated in enclave," *The National*, 30 July 2024.

away from this, as difficult that may be. After all, severe epidemics in the south of Gaza will bring victory closer and reduce casualties among the IDF soldiers."[32]

9. Systematically massacred starving civilians at "aid sites," killing around 100 persons per day for months. The Director of Doctors Without Borders (Médecins Sans Frontières) observed: "Children shot in the chest while reaching for food. People crushed or suffocated in stampedes. Entire crowds gunned down at distribution points. In MSF's nearly 54 years of operations, rarely have we seen such levels of systematic violence against unarmed civilians."[33]

On the Meaning of "Genocide"

While many genocides occurred before the 20th century, the term "genocide" was coined by Raphael Lemkin in 1944 and codified by Article 2 of the United Nations Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide in 1948. Some genocide scholars argue that the formal definition is outdated, or skewed to favor colonial powers, while others propose a variety of revisions.

"...the term does not necessarily signify mass killings although it may mean that. More often it refers to a coordinated plan aimed at destruction of the essential foundations of the life of national groups so that these groups wither and die like plants that have suffered a blight. The end may be accomplished by the forced disintegration of political and social institutions, of the culture of the people, of their language, their national feelings and their religion. It may be accomplished by wiping out all basis of personal security, liberty, health and dignity. When these means fail the machine gun can always be utilized as a last resort."

—Raphael Lemkin, "Genocide—A Modern Crime," *Free World* 4 (April, 1945): 39- 43.

"In the present Convention, genocide means any of the following acts committed with intent to destroy, in whole or in part, a national, ethnical, racial or religious group, as such:
(a) Killing members of the group;
(b) Causing serious bodily or mental harm to members of the group;
(c) Deliberately inflicting on the group conditions of life calculated to bring about its physical destruction in whole or in part;
(d) Imposing measures intended to prevent births within the group;
(e) Forcibly transferring children of the group to another group."

—Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide, "Article 2," OHCHR (9 December 1948)

[32] Cited in Gideon Levy, "Giora Eiland's Monstrous Gaza Proposal Is Evil in Plain Sight," *Haaretz*, 23 November 2023. (This disposition proved irrational and, after withholding Polio vaccines from Gaza for a time, Israel implemented extra health and vaccination measures to ensure IDF soldiers were not killed by their own campaign of total destruction.)
[33] Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF), "This is Not Aid. This is Orchestrated Killing." MSF, 2 August, 2025, https://www.msf.org/not-aid-orchestrated-killing.

1.1. Public Discernment of Genocide

When the human rights lawyer Francesca Albanese exposed the economic beneficiaries and corporate sponsors of Israel's program in her July 2024 report "From Economy of Occupation to Economy of Genocide,"[34] Google co-founder Sergey Brin was quick to dismiss the label of "genocide" along with the United Nations entirely. "With all due respect, throwing around the term genocide in relation to Gaza is deeply offensive to many Jewish people who have suffered actual genocides," he wrote. "I would also be careful citing transparently antisemitic organizations like the UN in relation to these issues."[35] Despite many holocaust survivors publicly speaking out against Israel's genocide, this sentiment throughout 2023-2025 was common. For Brin and others, it was impossible for Israel to be guilty of genocide because of the Jewish history/memory of the holocaust, and it is considered antisemitic for anyone to suggest otherwise.[36] For many others, Palestine and the "conflict" in Gaza is still an open "question." After all, in an age characterized by misinformation, disinformation, AI deepfakes, and state propaganda, how can one really know if genocide—or any kind of war crime or atrocity—is occurring anywhere at all?

Before answering this question, one must first ask another: "*Who or what is qualified to determine that a genocide or genocidal war is occurring or not?*" This question is not as difficult to answer: (a) scholars on genocide, human rights, and/or international law and (b) organizations specializing on genocide, human rights and/or violations of international law. These persons and groups are in the best position to provide a reliable answer to the public because making such determinations and warning the world about them is part of their job. Who is qualified to diagnose tooth decay? A dentist—someone who is trained to detect tooth decay and make judgments about oral health. Who can judge whether a group of cells in a person's leg is cancerous? A physician or team of physicians specializing in cancer. The same general principle applies to making judgments about genocidal acts—whether real, potential, or imagined.

This is not to suggest that the victims and those suffering eradication are not in a position to accurately identify what is happening to them. The Palestinians in Gaza know perfectly well that they are being starved to death and intentionally targeted because of who they are,[37] as did the Bosniaks in the 1990s, the Native American nations in the 1800s, and any other group enduring such consistent targeted violence. Labeling or not labeling it "genocide" also does not change the realities suffered or alter their depraved moral status. The voices of the suffering (especially those who are qualitatively and quantitatively suffering the most)

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[34] Francesca Albanese, "From economy of occupation to economy of genocide," Report of the Special Rapporteur on the situation of human rights in the Palestinian territories occupied since 1967, United Nations, 16 June 2025, https://www.ohchr.org/en/documents/country-reports/ahrc5923-economy-occupation-economy-genocide-report-special-rapporteur.

[35] Cited in Nitasha Tiku and Gerret De Vynck, "Google co-founder Sergey Brin calls U.N. 'transparently antisemitic' after report on tech firms and Gaza," *Washington Post,* 8 June 2025.

[36] On the charges of antisemitism in relation to criticism of Israel's actions, see Omar Shahabudin McDoom, "It's Hamas' Fault, You're an Antisemite, and We Had No Choice: Techniques of Genocide Denial in Gaza," *Journal of Genocide Research* (September 2025), 1–18; Raz Segal, "Settler Antisemitism, Israeli Mass Violence, and the Crisis of Holocaust and Genocide Studies." *Journal of Palestine Studies* 53, no. 2 (2024): 50–73; Jean Améry, *Essays on Antisemitism, Anti-Zionism, and the Left* (Studies in Antisemitism) (Indianapolis: Indiana University Press, 2022); Adam Sutcliffe, "Whose Feelings Matter? Holocaust Memory, Empathy, and Redemptive Anti-Antisemitism," *Journal of Genocide Research* 26, no. 2 (2024): 222–42; Norman Finkelstein, *The Holocaust Industry* (London: Verso, 2024); Asa Winstanley, *Weaponising Anti-Semitism* (New York: OR Books, 2023). As an example of how far this argument has been taken, in a 2005 *60 Minutes* interview with Australian journalist Richard Carleton, former Israeli minister Yuval Steinitz said Israel should be allowed to have (illegal) nuclear weapons because "we suffered [a] holocaust." Last available online at https://rumble.com/v6gfenm-2005-richard-carleton-does-real-journalism-as-he-asks-israeli-defence.html.

[37] Among countless such examples, see Muhammad Abu Salmiya, "Stop the Gaza genocide immediately," *The Lancet,* 403 no. 10441, P2286-2287, 25 May 2024.

must also be heard if there is any hope to ultimately mitigate such suffering. As the social ethicist Cornel West put it: "The vocation of the intellectual is to let suffering speak, let victims be visible, and let social misery be put on the agenda of those in power."[38]

The charge of "genocide" nevertheless remains weighty, pertinent, and often (needlessly) technical,[39] and there are also many atrocities that do not amount to genocide.[40] There is therefore particular value in third-parties, "independent judiciaries," and/or specialists. This is true even as all of these positions and entities are subjects that cannot escape subjectivity, contextualization, and various social power dynamics (i.e. politics). Indeed, as the history of the Gaza genocide indicates, the reporting and discourse of genocide is saturated in politics. Scholars played "wait and see" games when there was often little reason to wait and nothing more to see.[41] The ICC Prosecutor was threatened and sanctioned for issuing arrest warrants.[42] The President of the International Court of Justice plagiarized her dissenting opinion on genocide deliberations[43] (and later appealed to her personal theology in defense[44]). Civilians across western countries were arrested simply for protesting genocide[45] (or deported, or labeled "terrorists"[46]). Countries

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[38] Cornel West, *Cornel West: A Critical Reader* (Malden: Blackwell, 2001), 108.

[39] Martin Shaw, "The Genocide that Changed the World," *Journal of Genocide Research* (September 2025), 1-15, notes that "'Genocide,'...was never purely a technical legal term, and it is therefore wrong to treat it only as such, even in a court of law. Indeed, Lemkin himself developed it as a sociological and historical concept, and law needs, ultimately, to correspond to coherent sociological understanding."

[40] Popular ideas about genocide usually invoke sentiments like "killing everyone" or "killing mostly everyone." However, as noted in the info box above, that is not simply the case. Cf. A. Dirk Moses, *The Problems of Genocide: Permanent Security and the Language of Transgression* (Cambridge, Cambridge University Press, 2021).

[41] Note, for example, the comments by legal scholar Nimer Sultany on David Grossman's confession of Israel's genocide at https://x.com/NimerSultany/status/1951596738898235857, August 2, 2025, which highlight the centering of Jewish voices and morality, and blaming Palestinians for their own demise even in the context of condemning genocide. Legal scholar Alonso Gurmendi also commented on the same topic (August 2, 2025 at https://x.com/Alonso_GD/status/1951579718282551394) that "This 'I can't deny it any longer' angle was part of the global structure that enabled a genocide. What for you was a process of personal self discovery, for Palestinians it was months of atrocity denial where tens of thousands of people died, were tortured, starved, etc... as Bartov, Grossman etc open the Overton Window and more and more people cross it, I hope we can all agree on this side that it was not you who finally decreed this was a genocide and that there is some kind of merit to this. You were part of the reason the window stayed closed."

[42] Stéphanie Maupas, Benjamin Barthe David Hearst, "La campagne de pressions contre la CPI pour annuler le mandat d'arrêt contre Benyamin Nétanyahou," *La Monde,* 1 August 2025; David Hearst and Imran Mulla, "Exclusive: David Cameron threatened to withdraw UK from ICC over Israel war crimes probe," *Middle East Eye,* 9 June 2025; Karim Khan interview with Christiane Amanpour, "Exclusive: ICC Chief Prosecutor explains why he's seeking arrest warrants for leaders of Hamas and Israel," *CNN,* 20 May 2024, https://www.cnn.com/videos/tv/2024/05/20/amanpour-icc-karim-khan-arrest-warrants-hamas-netanyahu.cnn; Humeyra Pamuk and Stephani van den Berg, "Trump administration imposes sanctions on four ICC judges in unprecedented move," *Reuters,* 5 June 2025.

[43] Norman G. Finkelstein, *Gaza's Gravediggers: An Inquiry Into Corruption in High Places* (New York: OR Books, 2025); Rayhan Uddin, "ICJ president's plagiarism in Israel opinion 'reflects poorly', experts say," *Middle East Eye,* 29 January 2025.

[44] Judge Julia Sebutinde, cited in Anthony Wesaka, "My country disowned me after Israel–Gaza ruling – Sebutinde," *Monitor,* 13 August 2025.

[45] Jamin Andreas Hübner, "The Spring 2024 Campus Protests Against Genocide: Documentation of Assaulted and Arrested Professors," *CuriousJamin.com,* 2 April 2025, https://curiousjamin.com/2025/04/the-spring-2024-campus-protests-against-genocide-documentation-of-assaulted-and-arrested-professors/; Ruairi Casey, "Punched, choked, kicked: German police crack down on student protests," *Al Jazeera*, May 25, 2024; Azad Essa, "'A battle scene': The brutality of police raids at Columbia University and CCNY," *Middle East Eye*, 6 May 2024.

[46] Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights, "UK: Palestine Action ban 'disturbing' misuse of UK counter-terrorism legislation, Türk warns," United Nations, 25 July 2025; Noureldein Ghanem, "US protesters rally against Gaza genocide, students' arrests amid crackdown on pro-Palestine voices," *TRT Global,* 5 April 2025; Tessa Stuart, "Academics Sue To Block Trump From Disappearing Students Over Their Political Views," *RollingStone,* 29 March 2025. See also the references cited under the subheading "2025" below.

that tried to materially change the outcome of the genocide were bombed[47] or threatened with sanctions.[48] Academics were censored for speaking or writing on genocide and Palestinian liberation.[49] Genocide is inherently a *political* business—as well as an economic business with potentially enormous returns for investors.[50] These dynamics and motivations have the potential to skew judgments and derail efforts for justice.

Even so, such dynamics and motives do not remove the possibility of knowing what happened. It simply means that such factors must be properly taken into account when surveying the data, sources, and conclusions. We must not succumb to the cynicism that Hannah Arendt described:

> If everybody always lies to you, the consequence is not that you believe the lies, but rather that nobody believes anything any longer. This is because lies, by their very nature, have to be changed…a people that no longer can believe anything cannot make up its mind. It is deprived not only of its capacity to act but also of its capacity to think and to judge.[51]

The concern of this bibliography is primarily focused on the literary fruit of those qualified persons and groups whose particular task is to make determinations about genocidal events. This does not ignore disagreement amongst a community of qualified experts.[52] However, the kind of consensus achieved regarding the Gaza genocide is so overwhelming that such disagreement has now become quite superficial.[53] When both (a) independent international organizations *and (b)* large groups of holocaust and genocide scholars around the world examine a case study for months and come to the same conclusion, the public can be relatively certain that genocide has occurred. The very fact that "genocide" is being publicly debated by a wide variety of genocide experts means many red lines have already been crossed and dramatic intervention must be taken. Whether one believes in social "shunning" or not,[54] it is now

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[47] Jonathan Shamir, "A Void Only the Houthis Are Filling," *Jewish Currents,* April 15, 2025, https://jewishcurrents.org/houthis-yemen-red-sea-attacks-gaza-q-a.

[48] Nellie Peyton, "US lawmakers advance bill that could sanction South Africa over its foreign policy," Reuters, 30 July 2025.

[49] Ajay Skaria, "Gaza and the Unsettling Equality of Academic Freedom," *Critical Times* 8, no.1 (April 1, 2025): 33–84; Rafeef Ziadah, "Genocide, neutrality and the university sector," *The Sociological Review* 73 no. 2 (2025): 241-248; Walaa Alqaisiya and Nicola Perugini, "The Academic Question of Palestine," *Middle East Critique* 33, no. 3 (2024): 299–311; Sindre Bangstad, "The Palestine Exception to Academic Freedom and the IHRA Definition of Antisemitism," *The Journal of Imperial and Commonwealth History* 53, no. 3 (2025): 689–700; Sonia Boulos, "On the Use and Misuse of Academic Freedom," *Academe* (Winter 2025); Lana Tatour, "Censoring Palestine: Human Rights, Academic Freedom and the IHRA," *Australian Journal of Human Rights* 30, no.1 (2024): 106–14; European Legal Support Center (ELSC), "Index of Repression," index-of-repression.org; Natasha Lennard, "University Professors are Losing Their Jobs Over 'New MacCarthyism' on Gaza," *The Intercept,* 16 May 2024; Rashid Khalidi, "I spent decades at Columbia. I'm withdrawing my fall course due to its deal with Trump," *The Guardian,* 1 August 2025.

[50] In addition to Albanese, "From economy of occupation to economy of genocide" and Piette, "Behind Israel's 'end game' for Gaza," see Peter Hayes, *Profits and Persecution* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2025); Michael Thadd Allen, *The Business of Genocide* (Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press, 2002); A. Dirk Moses, *Empire, Colony, Genocide: Conquest, Occupation, and Subaltern Resistance in World History* (Oxford: Berghahn Books, 2008); Michel Chossudovsky, "Economic Genocide in Rwanda," *Economic and Political Weekly* 31, no.15 (April 13, 1996): 938-941; Mahmoud Mamdani, *Saviors and Survivors: Darfur, Politics, and the War on Terror* (New York: Crown, 2010).

[51] From Arendt's last public interview, with Roger Errera in *New York Review of Books,* 26 October (1978).

[52] Note the snapshot analysis in early 2025 by Shira Klein, "The Growing Rift between Holocaust Scholars over Israel/Palestine," *Journal of Genocide Research* (January, 2025), 1–21.

[53] Cf. Lederman, "A Not So Textbook Case of Genocide": "What followed [Spring 2025] seems to be a similar broad agreement emerging among legal scholars that this is indeed a genocide, and even those who are still hesitating find the genocide charges much more convincing." This becomes evident in the chronological bibliography below.

[54] See the debate over this topic between Norman Finkelstein and Cornel West, "Norman Finkelstein in Conversation with Cornel West and Nadine Strossen | Free Speech and Gaza," OR Books, 17 July 2025, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yBaGqy9h0eE.

justified to refer to those who deny the Gaza genocide as "genocide-deniers" no differently than those who deny the Nazi holocaust, Armenian genocide, Bosnian genocide, and others.

1.2. Method

Since this bibliography cannot be exhaustive, four general criteria are implemented to narrow down the selection:

1. *A general focus on Gaza*. While a sound case can be made for including the West Bank in a larger genocidal campaign against Palestinians (or Nakba),[55] this particular reference list remains mostly concerned with Gaza.
2. *Reports that address the genocide as real or impending*. This bibliography aims to capture the wide consensus in the field and achieve a workable size for publication. It is theoretically possible to provide an annotated bibliography of works arguing that Israel's actions do not amount to genocide. However, as it will become apparent below, this is not possible to achieve without incorporating (a) now thoroughly-outdated works, and (b) a host of irrelevant, less qualified, or unqualified parties—such as military generals, politicians, state actors, Israeli investors, colonial/Anglospheric parties enforcing their political responsibilities,[56] and other such groups.[57] This is why the next two criteria are crucial.
3. *Official reports by major organizations that partly or entirely exist to make such judgments*. These include such organizations as independent human rights organizations, university human rights organizations, genocide-prevention organizations, genocide research institutes and associations, international law organizations, human rights and international legal committees and offices of the United Nations, the Genocide Convention of the International Court of Justice (ICJ), the International Criminal Court (ICC), and the like. While such groups and institutions are not wholly unbiased (no organization is), these bodies are as qualified and credible as modern societies have been able to create thus far. Furthermore, since such organizations are known for favoring colonial violence and specifically shielding the state of Israel from responsibility,[58] it is all the more weighty and significant for such organizations to condemn or charge Israel for committing genocide.

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[55] See "Before October 7, 2023" below. On the "Nakba," see Ilan Pappe, *The Ethnic Cleansing of Palestine* (New York: Oneworld, 2007); Diana Allan (ed)., *Voices of the Nakba* (London: Pluto Press, 2021); Bashir Basher and Amos Goldberg (eds.), *The Holocaust and the Nakba* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2018); Rabea Eghbariah, "Toward Nakba as a Legal Concept," *Columbia Law Review* 124, no. 4 (2024): 887-992.

[56] See Jamin Andreas Hübner, "The West and the Rest: Eurocentrism, Colonialism, and Global Social Problems" in *The Palgrave Handbook to Global Social Problems*, ed. Rajendra Baikady (Cham: Palgrave Macmillan, 2025), at 14-16, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-68127-2_435-2.

[57] E.g., Bret Stephens, "No, Israel is Not Committing Genocide in Gaza," *The New York Times* (July 22, 2025); John Spencer, "I am a war scholar: there is no genocide in Gaza," *The Jerusalem Post* (July 27, 2025); Niall Ferguson, "Accusing Israel of Genocide in Gaza is a luxury belief—and utterly divorced from reality when there's a real one happening in Ukraine," *New York Post,* August 3, 2025.

[58] It is well-documented that institutions like the ICJ, ICC, and UN have a natural Eurocentric bent that favors Israeli political ambitions—such as settlement of both Gaza and the West Bank and the expulsion of Palestinians. On this subject, in addition to previous sources mentioned above, see Richard Falk, *Power Shift* (London: ZED, 2016); Antony Anghie, *Imperialism, Sovereignty and the Making of International Law* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2005); Makau Mutua, *Human Rights: A Political and Cultural Critique* (Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press, 2002); A. Dirk Moses, *Decolonization, Self-Determination, and the Rise of Global Human Rights Politics* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2022); A. C. Martineau, "Overcoming Eurocentrism? Global history and the Oxford handbook of the history of international law," *European Journal of International Law*, 25, no. 1 (2014): 329–336; Walter D. Mignolo, "Who Speaks for the 'Human' in Human Rights?" *Hispanic Issues On Line* 5, no. 1 (2009): 7–25; Siba N'Zatioula Grovogui, *Sovereigns, Quasi Sovereigns, and Africans* (Minneapolis: Minnesota University Press, 1996). On the role of Eurocentrism in the Gaza genocide, see Hübner, "The West and the Rest."

4. *Statements and analytical publications by genocide, holocaust, and international law scholars*. While many of the bodies and institutions under #3 above incorporate genocide specialists, there exist a body of experts that may or may not contribute to such organizations and publish independently. This group is notable because, as with #3 above, it is precisely their job to analyze, understand, and make authoritive judgments about such events. "Analytical publications" is an important qualifier, since expert opinion is not the same as scholarly analysis.[59] The opinion of a specialist who has not taken the time to review the evidence and arguments and engage with them in any depth is not particularly valuable. This bibliography therefore includes both statements and analytical publications, but underscores the latter (see use of asterisks below).

These criteria are the general guiding framework for what follows. Inevitably, there were some cases which required subjective judgments—works by those in adjacent disciplines, documents of secondary sources, popular essays, conference proceedings, etc. They were included for their usefulness and relevance to readers. Readers and others can determine for themselves if these judgment calls are warranted. However, it is important to note that even if these handful of dubious inclusions were discarded, this does not change the realities, or the robust consensus about the realities, of Israel's genocide in Gaza.

To delineate their relative importance, asterisks at the beginning of the entry (excluding pre-October 7, 2023 publications) rank their significance and authority:

1. *** for the most important and weighty publications;
2. ** for general works;
3. * for relevant and insightful works that are more complementary or supplemental to #1 (***) and #2 (**).

The listing is in chronological order for simplicity, but also so readers can trace the progression of genocide confirmation and regression of genocide denial. This is notable since many parties delayed any condemnation of Israel and/or any public use of "genocide" until an ever-new threshold was crossed—until, indeed, it was too late for genocidal prevention. Delaying, deferring, or denying was considered the "safe" option (!).[60] In creating this bibliography and further examining sources outside of it, the major thresholds for changing opinion appeared to be:

1. Israeli officials' public statements of genocidal intent by Prime Minister Netanyahu and Defense Minister Yoav Gallant the week following October 7, 2023. (Gallant announced a full siege without

[59] This was generally the case with two-page public letter of rejection of the International Association of Genocide Scholars' resolution condemning the Gaza genocide (found https://www.scholarsfortruthaboutgenocide.com/). It offered some brief rebuttals (several erroneous) and names of genocide scholars, but failed to engage in virtually any of the main arguments presented in works listed in this bibliography—and ignored the multiple letters by hundreds of holocaust and genocide scholars dating back to 2023. (It also forged the names of Professor Nathan Kalman and included double entries for Jonathan Skolnick at 75 and 263; Cary Nelson at 47 and 262; Sergei Kan at 253 and 273; Gunther Jikeli at 45 and 231, etc. Since virtually anyone could submit their signature online, the project quickly devolved into comical absurdity—including such entries as "Kees Baxter, Head Chocolate Maker," "508. Robert Cocop," and "513. Termen Ator, Professor, Center for Time Manipulation and Police Studies").

[60] One is reminded of Martin Luther King Jr.'s words: "On some positions, Cowardice asks the question, 'Is it safe?' Expediency asks the question, 'is it politic?' And Vanity comes along and asks the question, 'Is it popular?' But Conscience asks the question, 'Is it right?'" Cited in Clayborne Carson (ed.), *The Autobiography of Martin Luther King, Jr.* (New York: Warner Books, 2001), digital version. With Palestine practically beyond the point of no return—and wanting to distance themselves from the genocidal state publicly while materially supporting it, the United Kingdom, Australia, and Canada recognized the state of Palestine on September 21, 2025.

electricity, food, or fuel and that they were fighting "human animals."[61] Netanyahu referenced the divine call in Deuteronomy 25 to annihilate the Amalekites.[62] Both of these Israeli officials were issued arrest warrants by the International Criminal Court.[63])

2. The enormous and indiscriminate bombing campaign in Gaza by the IDF in 2023, coupled with more genocidal statements by Israeli officials about complete destruction.
3. The destruction of Rafah in May 2024 (where Palestinians fled south for safety, and did not find it).
4. The (resumed) blockade after Trump's ceasefire in January 2025.
5. The famine that arrived in 2025—anticipated by the Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) on July 29, 2025[64] and then declared on August 22, 2025.[65]
6. The back-to-back release of the IAGS Resolution of August 31st with the UN report of September 16, 2025, which made international headlines for clearly stating that Israel was committing genocide.

The bibliography itself is divided into the following four sections: (A) Before October 7, 2023; (B) 2023; (C) 2024; (D), 2025. Each section has an introduction. Annotations are crafted for a broad audience; they are not written for academics looking for specialized insight, and are strictly limited to 150 words. Credentials of authors are generally provided. To save space and be convenient, hyperlinks to the original source are embedded in each entry.

2. Annotated Bibliography

2.1. Section A: Before October 7, 2023

References to the genocide of Palestinians predate October 7, 2023. This is because "Genocide is a process, not an event."[66] Genocides do not suddenly and randomly occur, but emerge when various conditions are met through time.[67] In the case of Palestine, the historical process of genocide involved several key conditions and events:

1. *Nationalist Ideology (Zionism).* European Zionists (nationalists) from the late 1800s aimed to create a Jewish ethnostate—a state exclusive to Jews or under a Jewish majority. This generally required the separation, expulsion, and/or elimination of the existing native population.[68] According to some

[61] Emanuel Fabian, "Defense minister announces 'complete siege' of Gaza: No power, food, or fuel," *Times of Israel,* 9 October 2023.
[62] See the brief filed by South Africa at the ICJ (below in bibliography), as well as useful commentary by Noah Lanard, "The Dangerous History Behind Netanyahu's Amalek Rhetoric," *Mother Jones,* 3 November 2023.
[63] Office of the Prosecutor, "Statement of ICC Prosecutor Karim A.A. Khan KC on the issuance of arrest warrants in the Situation in the State of Palestine," *International Criminal Court,* 21 November 2024, https://www.icc-cpi.int/news/statement-icc-prosecutor-karim-aa-khan-kc-issuance-arrest-warrants-situation-state-palestine.
[64] IPC, "IPC Alert: Worse Case of Famine Unfolding in the Gaza Strip." This came just weeks after a (very poorly-aged) article appeared by Michael Ames, "The Gaza Famine Myth," *The Free Press,* 6 May 2025, who argued that there was no famine in Gaza because "the IPC has become the global gold standard for food security analysis" and hadn't declared it yet.
[65] IPC, "Famine confirmed in Gaza Governorate, projected to expand: 1 July - 30 September 2025," 22 August 2025. Netanyahu and other Israelis naturally called the famine declaration antisemitic and Hamas propaganda. Times of Israel staff, "Netanyahu's office calls Gaza famine declaration a 'modern blood libel'," *Times of Israel,* 22 August 2025.
[66] Sheri Rosenberg, "Genocide Is a Process, Not an Event," *Genocide Studies and Prevention* 7, no. 1 (2012).
[67] Cf. Mark LeVine, "Epilogue: The 116-Year War on Palestine," *Journal of Genocide Research* (September 2025), 1–11: "militant nationalism and settler colonialism, like hydrogen and oxygen producing water, will with few exceptions combine to produce the same outcome – genocide."
[68] On Israel as a settler colony, see Lorenzo Veracini, *Israel and Settler Society* (London: Pluto Press, 2006); Gershon Shafir, "Theorizing Zionist Settler Colonialism in Palestine" and Arnon Degani, "From Republic to Empire: Israel and the Palestinians after 1948" in *The Routledge Handbook of the History of Settler Colonialism*, edited by Edward Cavanagh and Lorenzo Veracini (London: Routledge, 2016); Areej Sabbagh-Khoury, *Colonizing Palestine* (Stanford: Stanford University Press, 2023); Nur Masalha, *Palestine:*

theories, this was supposed to secure a safe national home for Jews (or at least *abled Ashkenazi* Jews).[69] Zionism thus helped transform a Jewish religious identity into a Jewish *national* (i.e., political) identity. Argentina, Kenya, and other regions were considered, but Palestine was chosen as the location for the colony.

2. *Settler Colonization*. Toward that end, the Jewish Colonial Trust, Jewish National Fund, The Palestine Jewish Colonization Association (PICA), and other parties funded land purchases and migration in Palestine. The colonial, imperial, and occupying British government also approved the establishment of the Jewish national state for the European Zionists in the "Balfour Declaration" (1917). Terrorist organizations used force to create the new settler colonies with or without British help.[70] All of this spurred the Great Palestinian Revolt (1936-39) and then resulted in the forced removal of 700,000 Palestinians (Jewish, Christian, and Muslim) in 1948 along with the wholesale destruction of dozens of villages and death of thousands. This was the Palestinian "Nakba," or "Catastrophe," which created a major refugee crisis and forged various resistance groups (Fatah, PLO, PFLP, DFLP, PIJ, Hamas, etc.).
3. *Military Expansion and Occupation*. Seeking additional land and "permanent security,"[71] Israel enjoyed new imperial protection under the United States after the fall of the British Empire, occupying Egypt in 1956-57 and conquering Egypt, parts of Syria and Jordan, and the Palestinian territories after the 1967 war. Israel then invaded and/or tried to conquer Lebanon in 1978, 1982, 2006, and 2024, though only managing to occupy southern Lebanon. Israel's attempt at

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A Four Thousand Year History (London: Zed Books, 2018), "Chapter 10: Settler Colonialism and the Disinheriting of Palestinians"; Mahmoud Mamdani, *Neither Settler nor Native: The Making and Unmaking of Permanent Minorities* (Cambridge, MA: The Belknap Press of Harvard University Press, 2020); Jeff Halper, *Decolonizing Israel, Liberating Palestine* (London: Pluto Press, 2021).

[69] On Zionist eugenics and the persecution of non-Ashkenazi (or "inferior") Jews by Zionists, see Mamdani, *Neither Settler Nor Native*; Dafna Hirsch, "Zionist Eugenics, Mixed Marriage, and the Creation of a 'New Jewish Type'," *The Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute* 15, no. 3 (2009): 592-609; Sagit Mor, "'Tell My Sister to Come and Get Me Out of Here': A Reading of Ableism and Orientalism in Israel's Immigration Policy (The First Decade)," *Disability Studies Quarterly* 27, no. 4 (2007); Lily Galili, "Golda Meir Told Poland: Don't Send Sick or Disabled Jews to Israel," *Haaretz,* 9 December 2009; Gur Alroey, *An Unpromising Land* (Stanford: Stanford University Press, 2014); Gur Alroey, "'Between the Straights': Jewish immigration in the United States and Palestine, 1915-1925," *East European Jewish Affairs* 47, no. 2-3 (2017): 150-168; Tony Greenstein and Moshé Machover, *Zionism During the Holocaust: The Weaponization of Memory in the Service of State and Nation* (Tony Greenstein, 2022); Nir Hasson, "The Untold Story of the Jews Who Left Mandatory Palestine," *Haaretz,* 16 February 2018; Ofer Aderet, "These Jewish Migrants Survived Pogroms, Riots and Famine. Then They were Faced with Zionist Cruelty," *Haaretz,* 1 December 2021; Tom Segev, *1949: The First Israelis* (New York: Henry and Holt, 1986). Credit to historian Zachary Foster and his 13 August 2025 post on X.com for most of these references.

[70] Albert Einstein, et. al., "New Palestine Party: Visit of Menachem Begin and Aims of Political Movement Discussed," *The New York Times,* 4 December 1948; Albert Einstein, Letter to Shepard Rifkin (Executive Director of American Friends of the Fighters for the Freedom of Israel), 10 April 1948, https://www.deiryassin.org/images/EinsteinLetter041048.jpg; J. Bowyer Bell, *Terror Out of Zion* (London: Routledge, 1996); Joseph Heller, *The Stern Gang* (London: Routledge, 2015); Shlomo Shpiro, "The Intellectual Foundations of Jewish National Terrorism: Avraham Stern and the Lehi," *Terrorism and Political Violence* 25, no. 4 (2013): 606–20; Ami Pedahzur and Arie Perliger, *Jewish Terrorism in Israel Wars* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2011). Cf. Dina Siegel, *The Israeli Mafia* (Cham: Palgrave MacMillan, 2024); Aviva Gutman, *Operation Wrath of God: The Secret History of European Intelligence and Mossad's Assassination Campaign* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2025); Ronen Bergman, *Rise and Kill First: The Secret History of Israel's Targeted Assassinations* (New York: Random House, 2018).

[71] "Civilian destruction tends to be greatest when security retaliation reaches the level of what I have called 'permanent security'—extreme responses by states to security threats, enacted in the name of self-defense. Permanent security actions target entire civilian populations under the logic of ensuring that terrorists and insurgents can never again represent a threat. It is a project, in other words, that seeks to avert future threats by anticipating them today. Such aspirations are evident in many ongoing humanitarian crises." A. Dirk Moses, "Worse than Genocide," *Boston Review* (Fall 2023).

overthrowing Iran in 2025 similarly failed,[72] as did its bombing of Yemen in the same year.[73] Altogether, with western support, the IDF has engaged in continual, aggressive warfare and military operations against most of its neighbors for a half century ("living by the sword"). But despite setbacks—and inadvertently endangering itself by such aggression, prominent Israeli leaders publicly iterate plans to conquer parts of Saudia Arabia, Lebanon, Jordan, Syria, and Iraq to establish "Greater Israel."[74] Specializing in international arms dealing and weapons manufacturing, Israel also materially supported South African apartheid,[75] as well as the Bosnian, Rwandan, and Rohingyan genocides.[76]

4. *Apartheid*. Through its own discriminatory policies and law against Palestinians, Israel officially achieved apartheid status by the International Court of Justice in 2024.[77] (Note that apartheid is probably a "weak analogy."[78])
5. *Siege, Oppression, and "the Slow Genocide."* To deter Palestinian armed resistance and enact collective punishment on the population, the IDF implemented a blockade of Gaza in 2007—limiting its food supply, movement, commerce, etc.—and bombed it in various episodes ever since.[79] (Note that most of the 2 million residents of Gaza in 2023 were not "Gazans" but refugees from the Nakba who simply want to return to their homes.)

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[72] Reza Bagheri, "Zionist Defeat in Iran: The Triumph of National Identity over Aggression," *Middle East Critique* (2025), 1–6; Ori Goldberg, "How Israel failed in Iran," *Al Jazeera,* 24 June 2025; Javad Heiran-Nia and Hessam Habibi Doroh, "Why Israeli Attacks Brought Fear But Not Regime Change to Iran," *Stimson Center,* 1 July 2025.

[73] Tia Goldenberg, "Israel struggles to deter escalating attacks from Yemen's Houthi rebels as other fronts calm," *Associated Press*, 3 January 2025.

[74] Israel's first Prime Minister, David Ben-Gurion, said on May 24, 1948, "We should prepare to go over to the offensive. Our aim is to smash Lebanon, Trans-Jordan, and Syria…When we smash the [Arab] Legion's strength and bomb Amman, we will eliminate Transjordan too, and then Syria will fall. If Egypt still dares to fight on, we shall bomb Port Said, Alexandira, and Cairo." Michael Bar Zohar, *Ben Gurion: A Biography* (New York: Delacorte, 1978). Cf. Middle East Eye staff, "Bezalel Smotrich calls for Israel's borders to extend to Damascus," *Middle East Eye,* 11 October 2024; Times of Israel staff, "Netanyahu says he's on a 'historic and spiritual mission,' feels a connection to vision of Greater Israel," *Times of Israel,* 12 August, 2025; Sean Mathews, "Israel sees Sykes-Picot borders as 'meaningless', US envoy Tom Barrack says," *Middle East Eye,* 29 August 2025; OHCHR, "Report of the Special Committee to Investigate Israeli Practices Affecting the Human Rights of the Palestinian People and Other Arabs of the Occupied Territories," 5 September 2025.

[75] Sasha Polakow-Suransky, *The Unspoken Alliance: Israel's Secret Relationship with Apartheid South Africa* (New York: Vintage, 2010); lan Pappé, ed., *Israel and South Africa: The Many Faces of Apartheid* (London: Zed Books, 2015).

[76] Zachary Foster, "Israel's Support for Apartheid, War Crimes and Genocide Around the World, a Brief History," *Palestine Nexus*, 17 December 2024; John Brown, "Supreme Court rules against exposing Israel's role in Bosnian genocide," *+972 Magazine*, 5 December 2016. Note also Yair Aron, *The Banality of Denial: Israel and the Armenian Genocide* (London: Routledge, 2004).

[77] International Court of Justice, "Legal Cons.equences Arising from the Policies and Practices of Israel in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, Including East Jerusalem," 19 July 2024, https://www.icj-cij.org/sites/default/files/case-related/186/186-20240719-adv-01-00-en.pdf. Cf. Amnesty International, "Israel's apartheid against Palestinians: Cruel system of domination and crime against humanity," *Amnesty International,* 1 February 2022.

[78] "If anything, I think the apartheid analogy is often a weak analogy in relation to how the Palestinians are experiencing Zionism. In apartheid South Africa we never had the walls that we see in Israel. We never had
separate roads for black people and for white people as we see in Israel and in Palestine. We didn't have separate number plates for Arab cars. No, our courts never sanctioned collective punishment. Our courts never sanctioned torture, as the Israeli courts have. No, the apartheid regime never singled out for particular abuse the land, the destruction of the olive groves and their fruits." Farid Esack, cited in Naim Ateek, *A Palestinian Cry for Reconciliation* (Marynoll: Orbis Books), 158-9.

[79] Norman Finkelstein, *Gaza: An Inquest Into Its Martyrdom* (Berkely: University of California Press, 2018).

While there are many other events and dimensions to this subject, this five-point summary is sufficient to explain how and why Israel committed genocide.[80] A sixth bullet point of "Genocide" (or "The Fast Genocide") is a natural fit in this historical progression.

Some readers may consider this historical-contextual summary too critical or one-sided. But it is important to be reminded that non-genocidal societies do not commit genocide. Any appraisal of Israeli society must explain how its genocide originated without evading responsibility and framing it as "puzzle" or "mystery." *Genocide does not and cannot originate from a history, social structure, politic, and moral system that fundamentally opposes it.* Polls in January 2024 showed that 95% of Jewish Israelis thought the Israeli military was using either the "appropriate" amount of force or "too little" force in Gaza.[81] In summer 2025, 82% supported the ethnic cleansing of Gaza, 56% percent supported expelling Palestinian citizens of Israel,[82] 64% of Israelis and 76% of Israeli Jews believed "there are no innocents in Gaza."[83] Over decades of oppressing, dehumanizing, and killing Palestinians, Israel became a highly genocidal society so that genocide (along with public calls for extermination of the group) was an expected, programmatic outcome with strong community support.

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[80] For a general overview of this history, see Ilan Pappe, *A History of Modern Palestine,* 3rd ed. (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2022); Rashid Khalidi, *The Hundred Year War on Palestine* (New York: Metropolitan Books, 2020); Masalha, *Palestine*; Avi Shlaim, *Israel and Palestine* (London: Verso, 2009).

[81] The Peace Index, conducted by Nimrod Rosler and Alon Yakter, "Findings: The Peace Index, January 2024)," The Gershon H. Gordon Faculty of Social Sciences, Tel Aviv University, https://en-social-sciences.tau.ac.il/sites/socsci-english.tau.ac.il/files/media_server/social/peaceindex/2024-01-findings.pdf

[82] Shay Hazkani and Tamir Sorek, "Yes to Transfer: 82% of Jewish Israelis Back Expelling Gazans," *Haaretz*, 28 May 2025.

[83] Ido David Cohen, "64% of Israelis See No Need for More Reporting on Gazans' Sufferings," *Haaretz*, 10 June 2025; Alex MacDonald, "Vast majority of Israelis believe there are 'no innocents' in Gaza, says [Israeli] poll," *Middle East Eye* 26 August 2025.

Genocidal Indicators from Israeli Discourse

"There is no such thing as Palestinians…as a Palestinian nation. There is no Palestinian history. There is no Palestinian language."—Bezalel Smotrich (Finance Minister), cited in *Associate Press,* 20 March 2023

"Every child in Gaza is the enemy. We need to occupy Gaza and settle it, and not a single Gazan child will be left there. There is no other victory." —Moshe Feiglin, leader of Zehut, cited in *Maariv*, May 20, 2025

"The fact that there are 50 thousand dead in Gaza is necessary and required for the next generations…for each one [who was murdered] on October 7, fifty Palestinians have to die. It does not matter now children…I do not say it as a matter of revenge; it is a message for the next generations…every now and then they need a Nakba to feel the price." —Aharon Haliva, former head of IDF intelligence, cited in *The Independent,* 18 March 2024

"There are no innocent people in Gaza." —Avigdor Lieberman (Knesset), public post on X.com (November 30, 2023)

"Gaza will become a place where no human being can exist."—Giora Eiland (IDF Minister), to Israeli media (October 22, 2023), cited in *Al Jazeera,* 25 October 2023

"*[To] be clear, when we say that Hamas should be destroyed, it also means those who celebrate, those who support, and those who hand out candy — they're all terrorists, and they should also be destroyed."* —Ben Gvir (Minister of National Security) cited in *Times of Israel,* 10 January 2024

"I am full of hope and expectation that decision-makers will make it clear to the world about the updated goals of the war: crushing Gaza and all its inhabitants." —Eliyahu Revivo (Knesset), public post on X.com (November 1, 2023)

"I am personally proud of the ruins of Gaza, and that every baby, even 80 years from now they will tell their grandchildren what the Jews did…" —Bedra-Golan in front of Knesset (February 19, 2024)

"*The children in Gaza – the children in Gaza have brought this upon themselves!"*—Meirav Ben-Ari (Knesset), streamed live 16 October 2023

"The Gaza Strip should be flattened, and there should be one sentence for everyone there — death. We have to wipe the Gaza Strip off the map." —Yitzhak Kroizer (Knesset) cited in *Haaretz* 6 November 2023

"I felt like, like, like a Nazi … it looked exactly like we were actually the Nazis and they were the Jews." —IDF Soldier returning from Gaza; cited in *Haaretz,* 23 December 2024

"Think more in the direction of Auschwitz and the showers but without Nazis and without Hamas. Not by accidental fire, not by friendly fire, but premeditated murder: bombs with poison gas." —Dr. Maayan Sherman, on how Israelis gassed her son to death in Gaza; *Times of Israel,* 17 January 2024

"As Hitler, may his name be erased, once said: 'I cannot live in this world if there is one Jew left in it,' we could not live in this land if even one such Islamo-Nazi remains in Gaza, and not before we return to Gaza and turn it into Hebrew Gaza." —Moshe Feiglin, leader of Zehut, cited in *Middle East Eye*, 16 June 2024, in an interview with Israel Channel 12

Shaw, Martin. 'Palestine in an International Historical Perspective on Genocide' (*Holy Land Studies*, 9, no. 1 (2010): 1–25. Shaw (faculty of international relations at the Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals and of international relations and politics at Sussex University) is a leading genocide scholar who earned the Lifetime Achievement Award by the International Network of Genocide Scholars in 2022. This seminal article argues that Israeli actions against Palestinians, particularly in the Nakba, were genocidal. He also argues that genocide is a "general sociological concept which can be applied to many historical cases varying in scale, murderousness, ideological motivation, etc., so applying genocide analysis does not imply a comparison to any other specific case."

Shaw, Martin, and Omer Bartov. 2010. "The question of genocide in Palestine, 1948: an exchange between Martin Shaw and Omer Bartov," *Journal of Genocide Research* 12, no. 3-4, 243–259. Two genocide scholars debate whether the 1948 Nakba was genocide. Shaw asserts that it could be and Omer Bartov (Dean's Professor of Holocaust and Genocide Studies at Brown University) argues that it was not.

Cook, William (ed.). 2010. *The Plight of the Palestinians: A Long History of Destruction.* New York: Palgrave Macmillan. An original and impassioned collection of both academic and popular essays by those experiencing genocide in Palestine. Several chapters focus on genocidal features in Gaza and elsewhere. Particularly useful to understand the material realities of genocide instead of just the theory and analysis.

Shaw, Martin. 2013. "Palestine and Genocide: An International Historical Perspective Revisited." *Holy Land Studies* 12, no. 1, 1–7. Brief commentary that further explains Shaw's previous arguments about the genocidal nature of Israel's occupation of Palestine.

The Center for Constitutional Rights. August 26, 2016. "The Genocide of the Palestinian People: An International Law and Human Rights Perspective." The Center for Constitutional Rights (CCR) is an American non-profit legal organization founded in 1966 that uses strategic litigation and advocacy to challenge social oppression and protect constitutional and human rights. This 9-page document contends that the Palestinians are enduring genocide by Israel, along with other human rights abuses. They cite, among other things, the genocidal intent expressed by Israeli officials. For instance, "In August 2014, Moshe Feiglin, then-deputy speaker of the Israeli Knesset and member of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's ruling Likud Party, called for the destruction of Palestinian life in Gaza and offered a detailed plan for shipping Palestinians living in Gaza across the world."

Nijim, Mohammed. 2022. "Genocide in Palestine: Gaza as a Case Study." *The International Journal of Human Rights* 27, no. 1, 165–200. Written by a sociologist, this article "contends that Israeli policies that were enacted after the introduction of the siege in Gaza amount to slow-motion genocide," and that "genocide should be understood as a social practice rather than physical annihilation or merely mass killing of a group of people."

2.2. Section B: 2023

Before October, the year 2023 was the "deadliest year on record for children in the occupied West Bank."[84] However, the IDF's violence towards Palestinians would escalate far beyond this grim record in Gaza after Hamas militants escaped their prison fences on October 7. Their apparent aim in "Operation Al-Aqsa Flood" was to maximize damage primarily on the IDF[85] and capture hostages to use as bargaining chips in hopes of (a) breaking the devastating blockade of Gaza (which failed, at least in the short term), (b) retrieving Palestinian hostages/prisoners from Israeli prisons (which succeeded in November, 2023, February, 2025, and October 2025),[86] and (c) recentering Palestinian liberation from Israeli occupation while disrupting Israel's energy plan and normalization with Saudi Arabia—plans that were declared by Netanyahu weeks earlier at the United Nations General Assembly.[87] In a mixture of intentional violence and panic, approximately 1,200 were killed on October 7—including Israeli soldiers, security workers, civilians, children, foreign Thai workers, and others. An unknown number of these were killed by enormous Israeli friendly-fire[88] via the Hannibal Directive.[89] According to Israeli journalists, the IDF essentially allowed the attack to happen (presumably to justify the government's plans to conquer Gaza).[90] Sensational claims that Hamas beheaded babies and burned them in ovens circulated widely in western news (and were repeated by both American Presidents), but were subsequently debunked.[91] Claims of mass rape were similarly

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[84] Save the Children, "2023 marks deadliest year on record for children in the occupied West Bank," 18 September 2023, https://www.savethechildren.net/news/2023-marks-deadliest-year-record-children-occupied-west-bank.

[85] "Having watched almost all of the publicly available footage and images on the killings and their aftermaths, I noticed that the Hamas perpetrators also went after the domestic workers from Thailand, who were neither Jewish nor Israeli, but possibly perceived as 'aiding and abetting Zionism' by working in Israel. Hamas inadvertently also killed dozens of 'Arab Israelis' and Bedouins, which gives the raid more the quality of a terrorist attack, in which the perpetrators are not necessarily group selective." Uğur Ümit Üngör, "Screaming, Silence, and Mass Violence in Israel/Palestine," *Journal of Genocide Research* 1-9, 26 January 2024.

[86] Hundreds of hostages were successfully exchanged between Hamas and Israel. Note that in October 2023, Israel held 5,200 Palestinians in prison including 170 children (under 18). See *Al Jazeera*, "Why are so many Palestinian prisoners in Israeli jails?," 8 October 8 2023. On the use of "hostages" and "prisoners" to dehumanize Palestinians, see Jonah Valdez, "The Media Calls Israeli Captives "Hostages" and Palestinians "Prisoners,'" *The Intercept,* 13 May 2025. Cf. Emma Graham-Harrison and Yuval Abraham, "Israeli military database indicates only a quarter of Gaza detainees are fighters," *The Guardian,* 4 September 2025. The hostage exchange in October 2025 still left thousands of Palestinian hostages with no hope of return—including dozens of children.

[87] Benjamin Netanyahu, "Full Text of Netanyahu's UN address: 'On the cusp of historic Saudi-Israel peace'," *Times of Israel* (September 22, 2023).

[88] Itay Ilnai, "IDF embroiled in investigating itself in the wake of Oct. 7," *Jewish News Syndicate,* 5 February 2025: "...data revealed here for the first time shows that during the fighting on Oct. 7, the IAF fired 11,000 shells, dropped more than 500 one-ton bombs and launched 180 missiles...In total, the UAV array fired 240 missiles that day, causing 350 casualties, according to the investigation data."

[89] Yaniv Kubovich, "IDF Ordered Hannibal Directive on October 7 to Prevent Hamas Taking Soldiers Captive," *Haaretz,* 7 July 2024; Yonah Jeremy Bob, "IDF carried out Hannibal Directive, new 'Sword of Damocles' operation on October 7," *Jerusalem Post,* 27 February 2025; Richard Sanders and Al Jazeera Investigative Unit, "October 7: Forensic analysis shows Hamas abuses, many false Israeli claims," *Al Jazeera,* 21 March 2024.

[90] Rachel Fink, "New Evidence Reveals IDF Had Detailed Prior Knowledge of Hamas Plan to Raid Israel," *Haaretz,* 18 June 2024; Michael Hauser Tov, "Top IDF Commander Opted Not to Boost Security After Visiting Nova One Hour Before October 7 Hamas Massacre," *Haaretz,* 2 September 2025. Cf. Robert J. Jackson Jr. and Joshua Mitts, "Trading on Terror?" 6 December 2023. Available at SSRN: https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4652027.

[91] This is known as the "Hamas baby beheading hoax," which circulated throughout the media. To shore up support for Israel's invasion, U.S. President Biden claimed in a press conference just days after October 7 that he saw pictures of the decapitated infants—which was retracted almost immediately by the White House. Times of Israel Staff, "White House: Biden has not seen or independently confirmed Hamas beheaded Israeli children," *Times of Israel,* 12 October 2023. For a helpful summary of this debacle, see Assma Maad, William Audureau and Samuel Forey, "'40 beheaded babies': Deconstructing the rumor at the heart of the information battle between Israel and Hamas," *La Monde,* 3 April 2024. President Trump, similarly, reiterated the hoax saying he saw videos of "babies chopped up" on 18 September 2025 during an interview with the UK Prime Minister, as did Pete Buttigieg as late as October 1, 2025 in an interview with Andrew Callaghan. The sinister irony of this pervasive fiction was that for the next year,

debunked and the credibility of sexual violence remains disputed.[92] To manufacture consent for bombing Gaza's hospitals, Israel claimed Hamas ran a secret base under the al-Shifa hospital—which, along with the 3D videos of the alleged underground bunker,[93] proved false.[94] The attack gained permanent notoriety as "the deadliest attack on the Jewish people since the holocaust," though this is a historical overstatement.[95] Despite this extensive war-time propaganda and subsequent collective punishment in Gaza, the attack nevertheless shattered Israeli confidence in being able to "contain" Palestinians in what many have called "the largest open-air prison on earth"[96] by regularly "mowing the lawn."[97] Israeli leaders announced revenge in a variety of ways, and then initiated a massive ground invasion and bombing campaign across Gaza. Both the genocidal words and genocidal actions by Israel—especially in its historical context (see previous section), caused holocaust and genocide scholars to speak up and clarify that the genocide of Palestinians was about to accelerate into unprecedented destruction.

******Segal, Raz. October 13, 2023. "A Textbook Case of Genocide: Israel has been explicit about what it's carrying out in Gaza. Why isn't the world listening?" *Jewish Currents.*** A brief essay in a Jewish magazine by Raz Segal (Associate Professor of Holocaust and Genocide Studies and Endowed Professor in the Study of Modern Genocide at Stockton University), an Israeli historian residing in the United States. He urged readers to become aware of the impending genocide in Gaza based on the material actions of the IDF, the historical context of its military occupation, and the public statements of Israeli officials.

********Third World Approaches to International Law Review*. October 15, 2023. "Public Statement: Scholars Warn of Potential Genocide in Gaza."** Less than two weeks after the events of October 7, "over 800 scholars and practitioners of international law, conflict studies and genocide studies signed a public

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videos of actual beheaded and dismembered infants in Gaza saturated the social media timelines of millions across the world. (And, in contrast to the claims against Hamas, these atrocities were generally *not* used as public proof that Israeli culture or society was barbaric.)

[92] Tia Goldenberg and Julia Frankel, "How 2 debunked accounts of sexual violence on Oct. 7 fueled a global dispute over Israel-Hamas war," *Associated Press*, 22 May 2024; Omny Martone, Katie Knick, Lia McDonald Meteer, and Michelle Reilly, "Israel, Zionist Entities, and Palestine," Sexual Violence Prevention Association, 19 September 2025; Jeremy Scahill, Ryan Grim, and Daniel Bugslaw, "'Between the Hammer and the Anvil': The Story Behind the New York Times October 7 Exposé," *The Intercept,* 28 February 2024; Prem Thakker, "Did an Israeli Oct. 7 Witness Tell 'Many Lies' About Rape and Sexual Violence?," *Zeteo,* 10 April 2025. Cf. Office of the Special Representative of the Secretary General on Sexual Violence in Conflict, "Mission report Official visit of the Office of the SRSG-SVC to Israel and the occupied West Bank 29 January – 14 February 2024," United Nations, March 2024; Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights, "Report of the Independent International Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and Israel," 12 June 2024. To engage differing perspectives on this topic, readers should compare and contrast Arun Gupta, "Israel has manufactured an industrial-scale version of Jim Crow rape hoaxes," *Middle East Monitor,* 3 July 3 2024, and Ali Abunimah, "Debunking 'Screams Before Silence,' Sheryl Sandberg's 7 Oct. 'mass rape' film," *Electronic Intifada*, 4 May 2025, with the accounts of Rotem Izak, "Hamas' sexual crimes: Uncollected evidence come to light," *Ynet,* 18 November 2024, Liza Rozovsky, "15 Witnesses, Three Confessions, a Pattern of Naked Dead Bodies. All the Evidence of Hamas Rape on October 7," *Haaretz,* 19 April 2024, and Jerusalem Post Staff, " 'Wounded, terrified, bleeding, helpless': Ex-hostage Naama Levy speaks at NY event," *Jerusalem Post,* September 19, 2025.

[93] Oren Ziv, "How a Scottish maritime museuem ended up inISrael's 3D propaganda videos," +*972 Magazine,* 8 October 2025.

[94] Louisa Loveluck, Evan Hill, Jonathan Baran, Jarrett Ley and Ellen Nakashima, "The case of al-Shifa: Investigating the assault on Gaza's Largest Hospital," *Washington Post,* 31 December 2023.

[95] The deadliest attack(s) or series of massacres since the holocaust were likely the anti-Jewish Junta in Argentina in the late 1970s and early 1980s (ironically, enabled by Israeli arms sales). The Hamas October 7 attack was also largely indiscriminate and did not specifically target Jews.

[96] E.g., Ilan Pappe, *The Biggest Prison on Earth: A New Narrative of the History of the Occupied Territories* (Beirut: Nawfal/Hachette Antoine, 2020). Omar Shakir of HRW captures the general view that "Israel, with Egypt's help, has turned Gaza into an open-air prison." HRW, "Gaza: Israel's 'Open-Air Prison' at 15," 14 June, 2022, https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/06/14/gaza-israels-open-air-prison-15.

[97] See Finkelstein, *Gaza*.

statement warning of the possibility of genocide."[98] This substantial public warning came so early after the events of October 7 because Israel's genocidal intent was explicit from the start—and the IDF had already acted on it by cutting off the water and fuel supply to Gaza and its 2.1 million inhabitants.

Center for Constitutional Rights (CCR). October 18, 2023. "Emergency Legal Briefing Paper: Israel's Unfolding Crime of Genocide of the Palestinian People & U.S. Failure to Prevent and Complicity in Genocide." A 44-page document showing that the United States is in violation of international law and its own national laws regarding genocide in the case of Israel's invasion and destruction of Gaza.

United Nations. November 2, 2023. "Press Release: Gaza is 'running out of time' UN experts warn, demanding a ceasefire to prevent genocide." A press release revealing expert opinion on Palestinians in Gaza: "'We remain convinced that the Palestinian people are at grave risk of genocide,' the experts said. 'The time for action is now. Israel's allies also bear responsibility and must act now to prevent its disastrous course of action,' they said." The statement goes on to express concern about the targeting of apartment complexes in Jabalia refugee camp. This type of destructive activity would repeat itself for over a year so that most of the civilian infrastructure in Gaza was reduced to rubble before the end of 2024.

Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights. November 16, 2023. "Press Release: Gaza: UN experts call on international community to prevent genocide against the Palestinian people." This second UN release reiterates concern about public genocidal intent by Israeli officials, and notes that the IDF already "killed over 11,000 people, injured more than 27,000 and displaced 1.6 million persons since 7 October 2023, while thousands are still under the rubble. Of those killed, about 41 per cent are children and 25 percent are women. On average, one child is killed and two are injured every 10 minutes during the war, turning Gaza into a 'graveyard for children,' according to the UN Secretary-General."

Schabas, William. November 16, 2023. "Declaration of William A. Schabas in Support of Plaintiff's' Motion for Preliminary Injunction." *Defense for Children International – Palestine et al. v. Biden et al.* Schabas (faculty of international law at Middlesex University, UK, and faculty of international human law and human rights at Leiden University) was asked by the Center for Constitutional Rights to provide his support for the plaintiffs in *Defense for Children International – Palestine et al. v. Biden et al. (2023)*—plaintiffs which included several Palestinian Americans whose families were killed by the IDF in Gaza. This case was a lawsuit in the United States District Court for the Northern District of California against U.S. President Joe Biden, Secretary of Defense Lloyd Austin, and Secretary of State Antony Blinken for "failure to prevent and complicity in the unfolding genocide against Gaza." Schabas explained how Israel was committing genocide. The court acknowledged the possibility of genocide but dismissed the charge on technical grounds that foreign policy lay outside its jurisdiction.

John Cox, Victoria Sanford, and Barry Trachtenberg. November 16, 2023. "Declaration of John Cox, Victoria Sanford, and Barry Trachtenberg Schabas in Support of Plaintiff's' Motion for Preliminary Injunction." *Defense for Children International – Palestine et al. v. Biden et al. Further expert testimony in support of the plaintiffs in *Defense for Children International – Palestine et al. v. Biden et al. (2023)* (see previous). All three are leading scholars on genocide: Cox is the Director of the Center for Holocaust, Genocide & Human Rights Studies at University of North Carolina; Sanford is the Founding Director of the

[98] Note that this public statement reflects the Third World Approaches to International Law (TWAIL), which is a school of international legal scholarship that reveals how international law is regularly used to subordinate the Global South to western economies, companies, and states.

Center for Human Rights and Peace Studies at Lehman College and an Advisory Board member of the CUNY Center for the Study of the Holocaust, Genocide, and Crimes Against Humanity; Trachtenberg was Michael H. and Deborah K. Rubin Presidential Chair of Jewish History and is a scholar on Jewish history and the holocaust.

Jabarin, Shawan, and Ahmed Abofoul. November 11, 2023. "We are Witnessing a Genocide Unfolding in Gaza: To Stop it, the ICC Prosecutor Must Apply the Law Without Fear or Favour." *OpinioJuris.* An essay by two Palestinian legal scholars Jabarin (General Director of Al-Haq) and Abofoul (international lawyer, legal researcher at Al-Haq, and a research fellow on international law and legal mobilization at the International Institute of Social Studies of Erasmus University Rotterdam), which notes Palestinian adherence to the International Criminal Court (ICC), Israel's long-time occupation of Palestine, the inconsistency and double-standards of international law applied to Palestine and Israel, and implore the Prosector to be consistent and charge Israel for genocide.

Moses, A. Dirk. November 20, 2025. "More Than Genocide." *Boston Review* (Fall, 2023). Moses (editor-in-chief of *The Journal of Genocide Research*) pessimistically reflects on the narrow use of "genocide" and asks "why this claim of genocide has not gained significant traction beyond the protest movement." Although the claim would gain traction in following months, Moses insightfully explores the nature of state and colonial violence: "Throughout the five-hundred-year history of Western empires, the security of European colonizers has trumped the security and independence of the colonized.... Antiterrorism operations that kill thousands of civilians are taken to be acceptable responses to terrorist operations that kill far fewer civilians. Indigenous and occupied peoples, then, are placed in an impossible position. If they resist with violence, they are violently put down. If they do not, states will overlook the lower-intensity but unrelenting violence to which they are subject." Thus, "The UN [Genocide Convention] does not reflect the victim's perspective. It protects the perpetrators: states that seek permanent security."[99]

***Democracy for the Arab World Now (DAWN). December 4, 2025. "The Question of Genocide."** A 24-page summary of "the proceedings at 'The Question of Genocide,' a workshop convened by Democracy for the Arab World Now (DAWN), in partnership with the American Friends Service Committee (AFSC), the Lemkin Institute for Genocide Prevention, Law for Palestine, and the Center for Constitutional Rights on December 4, 2023 at the Church Center for the United Nations in New York. The workshop gathered scholars, lawyers, diplomats, and foreign policy experts to examine the facts and the law for a determination of whether Israel is committing the crime of genocide against Palestinians in Gaza." Several experts concluded that Israel was already committing genocide.

Shlaim, Avi. December 6, 2023. "All That Remains," *Prospect. Shlaim (faculty emeritus of international relations at Oxford University), a former member of the IDF and Arab Jew from Iraq, contextualizes Israel's genocidal war with Hamas. He notes that "Hamas is not a terrorist organization pure and simple, as Israel media and its western allies keep insisting. It is a political party with a military wing whose attacks on civilians constitute terrorist acts...It is a mass social movement." This is notable because Israel's defense was that they were merely "eliminating terrorists." However, labelling a group "terrorist" is not a license for extermination, and calling a group "terrorist" does not mean that intentionally exterminating them is not

[99] Contrast with Shaw, *The New Age of Genocide*.

genocide. (Victims of genocide and war crimes always bear dehumanizing labels such as "vermin," "animals," "savages," "barbarians," "insurgents," "agitators," "filth," "terrorists," etc.)

***Segal, Raz, et. al. December 7, 2023. "Statement of Scholars in Holocaust and Genocide Studies on Mass Violence in Israel and Palestine since 7 October." *Contending Modernities* (University of Notre Dame).** A public statement jointly signed by over 55 holocaust and genocide scholars warning of impending genocide in Gaza. The authors begin by saying, "We, scholars of the Holocaust, genocide, and mass violence, feel compelled to warn of the danger of genocide in Israel's attack on Gaza." In their conclusion, after calling on governments to act and fulfill their international obligations to prevent genocide, they "also call on businesses and labor unions to ensure that they do not aid and abet Israeli mass violence, but rather follow the example of workers in Belgium transport unions who refused in late October to handle flights that ship arms to Israel. Finally, we call on scholars, programs, centers, and institutes in Holocaust and Genocide Studies to take a clear stance against Israeli mass violence and join us in efforts to stop it and prevent its further escalation."

***The International Federation for Human Rights. December 12, 2023. "Resolution on Israel's unfolding crime of genocide and other crimes in Gaza and against the Palestinian People."** The International Federation for Human Rights (FIDH) is an organization making up 188 member organizations on human rights. It is based in Paris and passed a resolution at its Meeting of the International Board in November 2023, where the Federation "recognises that Israel's actions against the Palestinian people constitute an unfolding genocide. States and individuals who provide assistance to Israel are hereby rendering themselves complicit." The resolution outlines the context of apartheid and the Nakba, illegal military occupation, and the blockade of Gaza.

Lemkin Institute for Genocide Research. December 29, 2023. "Statement on Why We Call the Attack on Gaza Genocide." Raphael Lemkin coined the termed "genocide" in 1944. The Lemkin Institute for Genocide Prevention (founded 2017) aims to prevent genocide in Lemkin's legacy. The report contains multi-contextual analyses to conclude genocide committed by Israel. While conclusive and timely, the report unfortunately includes accusations about the Hamas attack that were either unverified or debunked as Israeli propaganda (such as "the ablation of a breast that was tossed around among the men"). In saying that Israel was committing genocide and "exhorts the international community to immediately withdraw support for Israel, especially military support. Israel is a genocidal state that must be brought back into the framework of the rule of law," the report also inaccurately suggests that Israel was under the rule of law prior to October 7, 2023. (For similar problems, see "Our Genocide" under 2025.)

South Africa. December 29, 2023. "Application of the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide in the Gaza Strip (*South Africa v. Israel*)." International Court of Justice. *South Africa vs. Israel. This 194-page document contains South Africa's lawsuit against Israel at the Genocide Convention of the International Court of Justice. As with the two earlier publications mentioned above, the extensive damage by this time and the public intent of genocide was so compelling that it demanded legal intervention. In response, the ICJ ruled in a 14-2 vote on January 6, 2024 that the possibility of genocide is plausible and therefore remains an open case. (Why did South Africa act and not one of the other 190+ UN countries? Probably because Israel facilitated and directly supported the South African apartheid regime, its technologies, and militaries until its collapse in the 1990s.[100])

[100] Polakow-Suransky, *The Unspoken Alliance*; Pappé, *Israel and South Africa*; Mamdani, *Neither Settler Nor Native*.

2.3. Section C: 2024

2024 continued the same patterns of destruction in Gaza as in 2023, amassing casualties and leaving a trail of mass graves across Gaza. In April-May, a global movement of university encampments in solidarity with Palestine emerged only to be ruthlessly crushed by the police in countries like the Netherlands, Germany, and United States.[101] In autumn, the International Criminal Court issued arrest warrants on a leader of Hamas (by that time, deceased), as well as Yoav Gallant and Benjamin Netanyahu for using starvation as a weapon of war and other charges. Israel, meanwhile, invaded Lebanon but failed, even after carrying out one of the most technologically-advanced terrorist attacks in history.[102]

Shaw, Martin. January 3, 2024. "Inescapably Genocidal," *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–5. Reveals how the war in Gaza by Israel was "inescapably genocidal," giving attention to the qualifying criteria.

***Mordecai, Lee. January, 2024 (updated to July 5, 2025). "Bearing Witness to the Israel-Gaza War." Available at: witnessing-the-gaza-war.com.** Mordecai (Senior Lecturer in history at Hebrew University in Jerusalem) compiled an extensive 232-page document of the genocide, including many references to first-hand video evidence posted on public social media. As he writes: "I, Lee Mordechai, a historian by profession and an Israeli citizen, bear witness in this document to the horrible current situation in Gaza as events are unfolding. The enormous amount of evidence I have seen, much of it referenced later in this document, has been enough for me to believe that Israel is currently committing genocide against the Palestinian population in Gaza."

El-Affendi, Abdelwahab. January 18, 2024. "The Futility of Genocide Studies After Gaza." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–7. This article suggests that the failure to condemn the Israeli genocide in Gaza and the insistence to defend Israel is undermining the concept of genocide itself. (This thesis is similar to remarks written later by international law professor Neve Gordon of Queen Mary University, London: "If the world accepts the way Israel now interprets the principle of proportionality, then genocide will become justified."[103]) El-Affendi concludes that the formal debate about genocide is not even what matters anyway: "if a series of actions approach genocide sufficiently to occasion a debate on whether they are genocide or not, then they are evil enough to be denounced without ifs or buts; even more so if the aim is to sustain an unjust system."

South Africa. January 26, 2024. "Order of January 26, 2024." Case #192, *Israel vs. South Africa*. Because of Israel's continued assault and because of South Africa's complaints, the ICJ issued an order for Israel to prevent acts that could be considered genocidal, to refrain from inciting genocide, and to ensure humanitarian assistance reaches civilians in Gaza while also preserving evidence of genocide and

[101] See references under point 7 in the "Introduction" above, as well as Jane Kenway and Katie Maher, "Encampment pedagogies: lessons learned from students for Palestine," *Curric Perspect* 44 (2024): 389–393; AJ Labs, "Mapping pro-Palestine college campus protests around the world," *Al Jazeera,* 2 May 2024; and also the documentary, *The Encampments* (2025).
[102] Justin Salhani, "Exploding pagers, psychological warfare: Israel's attack on Hezbollah," *Al Jazeera,* 18 September 2024; Michael Walzer, "Israel's Pager Bombs Have No Place in a Just War," *The New York Times,* 21 September 2024; Alameddine Ramzi, Noureddin Baha', Mansour Ahmad, *et al.,* "The synchronized pager explosions: an unprecedented pattern of injuries," *World Journal of Emergency Surgery* 20, no. 70 (2025).
[103] Neve Gordon, "Israel seeks to rewrite the laws of war," *Aljazeera,* 15 July 2024. Cf. Martin Shaw, *The New Age of Genocide: Intellectual and Political Challenges after Gaza* (New Castle Upon Tyne: Agenda Publishing, 2025).

reporting back to the court on its compliance regarding these orders. (Israel and the IDF essentially ignored these orders.)

****Üngör, Uğur Ümit. January 26, 2024. "Screaming, Silence, and Mass Violence in Israel/Palestine," *Journal of Genocide Research* 1-9.** A Dutch-Turkish scholar of genocide (Professor of Sociology at the NIOD Institute for War, Holocaust and Genocide Studies) writes about the genocidal character of Middle-Eastern violence at large. In speaking about Israel's invasion of Gaza in particular, he notes seven genocidal characteristics such as "the attacks on hospitals, schools, journalists, the university, and other civilian infrastructure cannot be interpreted other than an attempt to make Gaza unlivable and render a future unimaginable…Israel's deployment of non-conventional weapons like white phosphorus has no military use but only serves to massacre and terrorize civilians… targeted attacks on cultural heritage such as the Gaza local archives, public and university libraries, bookshops, manuscript collections, ancient mosques, tombs, temples, bathhouses, museums, monasteries, churches, castles, cemeteries, and many archaeological sites erase the memory of Palestinian culture."

****Shmuel, Lederman. January 29, 2024. "Gaza as a Laboratory 2.0," *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–6.** Gaza is notoriously known for being a "laboratory" of Israeli weapons-testing.[104] (The British began weapons-testing on Arabs in West Asia/Middle East in the 1920s.[105]) Schmuel (The Weiss-Livnat Center for Holocaust Research and Education, University of Haifa) argues that Israel's actions in Gaza have the "dynamics" of genocide, but is not yet a genocide proper. (Schmuel changed his views months later to affirm a simple genocide verdict.)

***Jamshidi, Maryam. February 8, 2024.** "**Reflecting on Genocidal Intent in the ICJ Case." *OpinioJuris*.** One of the many arguments Israel used to justify its destruction of Gaza and its inhabitants is (to paraphrase) "We're only trying to defeat the organization of Hamas, not destroy and occupy Gaza as a whole." However, this brief essay by a law professor shows that "Instead of undercutting South Africa's genocide case, Israel's desired elimination of Hamas provides more proof that its actions satisfy the Convention's definition of genocide. As Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu wrote in a December *Wall Street Journal* op-ed, destroying Hamas means eliminating both its 'military capabilities' and 'political rule over Gaza.' As reflected in that statement, other statements made by the Israeli government, as well as Israel's actions on the battlefield, the Israeli government's desired destruction of Hamas includes the annihilation of its civilian political and administrative leadership."[106]

****Human Rights Watch. February 26, 2024. "Israel Not Complying with World Court Order in Genocide Case."** Human Rights Watch is one of the world's leading human rights organizations. This brief analysis shows that Israel has failed to obey the ICJ court orders to cease genocidal acts. (This obviously implied that genocidal acts were being committed, but HRW wouldn't concede this general conclusion until later.)

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[104] Antony Loewenstein, *The Palestine Laboratory* (London: Verso, 2023).

[105] Caroline Elkins, *Legacy of Violence: A History of the British Empire* (Cambridge: Belknap, 2022).

[106] Contrast with Moses, "More Than Genocide": "Most Western states…have not pressed the Israeli government to explain how cutting off water, food, and power to Gaza—a 'war of starvation' as the Euro-Med Human Rights Monitor put it—is a legitimate military tactic, one not covered by the UNGC, which declares one genocidal predicate act to be 'deliberately inflicting on the group conditions of life calculated to bring about its physical destruction in whole or in part.' But if so-called humanitarian pauses are occurring to allow in a little, if grossly inadequate, aid, and the 'total siege' is lifted after the military defeat of Hamas (should it happen), it will be difficult to argue in a legal context that Israel's strangling of Gaza was a genocidal act."

Segal, Raz, and Luigi Daniele. March 5, 2024. "Gaza as Twilight of Israel Exceptionalism: Holocaust and Genocide Studies from Unprecedented Crisis to Unprecedented Change." *Journal of Genocide Research*, March, 1–10. Segal and Daniele (Centre for Rights and Justice, Nottingham Trent University) show the double standards with regard to the claim of genocide between Russia's invasion of Ukraine and Israel's invasion of Gaza. The former was called genocide but, even though Israel's invasion of Gaza greatly exceeds such conceptions of genocide, was not called genocide.

Oxfam. March 15, 2024. "Inflicting Unprecedented Suffering and Destruction: Seven Ways the Government of Israel Is Deliberately Blocking and/or Undermining the International Humanitarian Response in the Gaza Strip." A 24-page report by a leading international human rights organization founded in the UK, which examines the various ways in which Israel was blocking humanitarian aid into Gaza and killing those seeking aid. At this point, Oxfam emphasized a "serious risk of genocide" (p. 15).

South Africa. March 28, 2024. "Order of March, 2024." *Israel vs. South Africa*. By March, the population in Gaza was evacuated to the south refugee camp of Rafah. The court called on Israel to ensure basic provisions to avoid further humanitarian catastrophe, saying: "This perilous situation demands immediate and effective implementation of the provisional measures indicated by the Court in its Order of 26 January 2024, which are applicable throughout the Gaza Strip, including in Rafah, and does not demand the indication of additional provisional measures." Invading Rafah was said to be a "red line" by President Biden.[107] The Prime Ministers of New Zealand, Australia, and Canada (the Anglosphere)[108] even issued a joint statement condemning Israel's plans to invade Rafah.[109] However, Israel ignored these orders and warnings,[110] and starting on May 6, bombed Rafah so severely that its destruction was visible from space.[111] None of Israel's allies withdrew support from Israel.

Bastaki, Jinan. April 5, 2024. "Gaza, Forced Displacement, and Genocide." *EJIL:Talk!* (European Journal of International Law). A concise essay by a law professor demonstrating that Israel's invasion and conduct in Gaza fulfills the strict legal criteria of genocide and also constitutes war crimes.

***Stern-Weiner, Jamie (ed.). April 16, 2024. *Deluge: Gaza and Israel from Crisis to Cataclysm*. New York: OR Books.** The first edited volume on the subject. Less focus on historical and legal aspects, and more focus on social, political, and geographic perspectives. Contains several chapters on the nature of violence and resistance.

Whyte, Jessica. April 17, 2024. "A 'Tragic Humanitarian Crisis': Israel's Weaponization of Starvation and the Question of Intent," *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1-15. Written by a philosophy and law

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[107] Carlo Martuscelli, "Biden warns of 'red line' for Israel over Rafah." *Politico,* 10 March 2024.

[108] "Palestinian liberation from Israeli settler colonialism, for example, reveals itself as a global fault line for colonial cooperation…" Hübner, "The West and the Rest."

[109] "We are gravely concerned by indications that Israel is planning a ground offensive into Rafah. A military operation into Rafah would be catastrophic. About 1.5 million Palestinians are taking refuge in the area, including many of our citizens and their families. With the humanitarian situation in Gaza already dire, the impacts on Palestinian civilians from an expanded military operation would be devastating. We urge the Israeli government not to go down this path. There is simply nowhere else for civilians to go." Anthony Albanese, Justin Trudeau, Christopher Luxon, "Joint statement by the Prime Ministers of Australia, Canada and New Zealand." Office of the Prime Minister of Australia, 15 February 15 2024. Available online: https://www.pm.gov.au/media/joint-statement-prime-ministers-australia-canada-and-new-zealand-0

[110] They actually asked the court to dismiss the order. Reuters staff, "Israel asks World Court to reject request for Rafah emergency orders," Reuters, 15 February 2024.

[111] Jake Godin, "Satellite Imagery Shows Vast Destruction in Rafah," *Bellingcat* (August 27, 2024). Available online: https://www.bellingcat.com/news/2024/08/27/satellite-imagery-shows-vast-destruction-in-rafah/

professor specializing in human rights and political economy, this article looks at how Israel used starvation as a weapon of war (a specific war crime that was later used by the ICC to issue arrest warrants on Netanyahu and Gallant) and the intent criteria of genocide. She shows how Israel uses a flexible interpretation of the international humanitarian law prohibition of starving civilians to portray its starvation campaign as a "tragic humanitarian crisis." This thesis was later iterated by Albanese (below). (Note that a cabinet transcript from March 1, 2025 leaked to Israel Channel 13 in August 2025 confirmed that the IDF was intentionally starving Gaza as a strategy to defeat the Palestinian resistance.[112])

**Wilde, Ralph. April 22, 2024. "Legal Consequences for third States of Israel's potential breaches of the Genocide Convention in the light of the ICJ's Provisional Measures Orders in the *South Africa v Israel* case: Legal Opinion for the Arab Organisation for Human Rights in the UK." Wilde (faculty of laws, University College of London) provides a 38-age analysis published by a UK human rights organization of what states are required to do as a result of the ICJ's orders. He notes that "The effect of the ICJ's determination is that States must proceed on the basis of a working assumption that Israel is violating the genocide obligations, and there is a risk that these violations will continue, and other violations will arise…" This is important because (contrary to dissenting opinion)[113] it is irrelevant whether the ICJ ultimately determines Israel to be committing genocide or not: UN member states have an obligation to mitigate all risks in their involvement (and non-involvement) with the state of Israel immediately. (Virtually none of them did.)

*McDoom, Omar Shahabudin. April 25, 2024. "Expert Commentary, the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict, and the Question of Genocide: Prosemitic Bias within a Scholarly Community?" *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–9. McDoom (Dept of Government, London School of Economics) reveals biases in favor of Israel when assessing Israel's assault on Gaza—especially pro-Israel biases by genocide and holocaust scholars.

**Sultany, Nimer. May 9, 2024. "A Threshold Crossed: On Genocidal Intent and the Duty to Prevent Genocide in Palestine." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–26. Nimer Sultany (School of Law, SOAS University of London) focuses on the intent criteria and legal consensus of genocide, showing how "the military logic of defeating an enemy in war has been crossed into the genocidal logic of elimination." The article also highlights "how much of the mainstream commentary in the months that followed 7 October portrayed the eventual destruction of most of Gaza as an incidental outcome of urban warfare rather than the predictable outcome of a policy," and concludes that "apartheid and genocide give a relatively more comprehensive, and thus more accurate, framework for describing and analysing what Israel has inflicted on the Palestinian people after decades of depriving them of the right to self-determination."

**Goldberg, Amos. May 14, 2024. "Yes It is Genocide." *Jewish Voice for Labour.* Goldberg (Professor of Holocaust History at Hebrew University of Jerusalem) wrote a brief essay for a Jewish publication explaining the genocide in Gaza, concluding: "Yes, it is genocide. Although it is so difficult and painful to admit this and despite all efforts to think otherwise, at the end of six months of a brutal war it is no longer

[112] Middle East Eye staff, "Leaks reveal Netanyahu deliberately imposed starvation in Gaza to 'force Hamas to surrender," 7 August 2025.
[113] E.g., "Genocide at the ICJ must be proven fully conclusively, meaning there can be no other possible explanation." Scholarsfortruthaboutgenocide.com.

possible to escape this conclusion. Jewish history will henceforth be stained with the mark of Cain of the 'crime of crimes,' which cannot be erased from its forehead. As such, it will stand trial for generations."

***University Network for Human Rights. May 15, 2024. "Genocide in Gaza." A 105-page report by a group of four major law schools. The University Network for Human Rights is comprised of the International Human Rights Clinic at Boston University School of Law, the International Human Rights Clinic at Cornell Law School, the Centre for Human Rights at the University of Pretoria, and the Lowenstein Human Rights Project at Yale Law School. Their extensive report documents Israel's genocide in Gaza from every major angle.

**South Africa. May 29, 2024. "Letter dated 29 May 2024 from the Permanent Representative of South Africa to the United Nations addressed to the President of the Security Council." This dossier from South African representatives to the Security Council of the United Nations documents Israel's genocidal intent and public incitement to genocide. It is particularly significant since genocidal intent is often the most difficult criteria to discern and/or prove. This dossier did not succeed in discouraging Israel and Israelis from inciting genocide. Furthermore, the Security Council failed to act in response to this information and, regrettably, failed to act in response to all further reports. (This is because the outdated rules of the Security Council require a unanimous vote for action instead of a majority or supermajority vote,[114] and the United States uses its single vote to veto anything meaningful against Israel.)

*Badarin, Emile. "Foreign Policy and the Performance of Collective State Recognition Amidst Genocide." *Middle East Critique*, 33 no. 4 (2024), 635–654. A Palestinian scholar of settler colonial politics unfolds the performative (and relatively meaningless) act of western recognition of the Palestinian state during the genocide of Palestinians in Gaza.

*Neier, Aryeh. June 6, 2024. "Is Israel Committing Genocide?" *New York Review of Books.* Neier is the co-founder of Human Rights Watch and head of the American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU), whose Jewish parents fled Nazi Germany to escape the holocaust. In June, he told CNN he now believes Israel is committing genocide in Gaza after "witnessing how Israel has systematically deprived Gaza's civilian population of food and water."[115] In this essay for the *New York Review of Books*, he also describes how HRW and human rights orgs make judgments for war crimes and other atrocities, and explains the logic behind his condemnation of the Gaza genocide. (HRW condemned Israel's actions in Gaza but would not condemn them as genocide until December 19).

***Office of High Commissioner for Human Rights: Independent International Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and Israel. June 10, 2024. "Detailed findings on the military operations and attacks carried out in the Occupied Palestinian Territory from 7 October to 31 December 2023." A substantial 126-page report documenting the wide variety and extent of Israel's war crimes and violations of international law. It gives special attention to Israel's incitement of genocide and violation of ICJ orders regarding genocide prevention and compliance with international law.

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[114] For an introduction to sound democratic rules and procedure, see The American Institute of Parliamentarians, *The American Institute of Parliamentarians Standard Code,* 2nd ed. (Albany: American Institute for Parliamentarians, 2024) and *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised,* 12th ed. (New York: Public Affairs, 2020).

[115] Middle East Monitor staff, "HRW founder changes mind on Israel genocide charge," *Middle East Monitor* 19 May 2024, referring to the interview by Sophie Tanno, "Human Rights Watch accuses Israel of genocide by 'deliberately' restricting water in Gaza," *CNN*, 19 December 2024, https://edition.cnn.com/2024/12/19/middleeast/hrw-israel-genocide-restricting-water-intl/index.html

Oxfam International. "Water War Crimes." July 18, 2024. A major report that documents Israel's war crimes of destroying water supplies and sanitation systems in Gaza. They argue that, in addition to violating various international laws, "the Government of Israel's denial of water for drinking and cooking is a key part of South Africa's claim that there is a plausible case that the Government of Israel is violating the rights of the Palestinian people under the Genocide Convention."

Albanese, Francesca. July 1, 2024. "Anatomy of a Genocide – Report of the Special Rapporteur on the situation of human rights in the Palestinian territory occupied since 1967 to Human Rights Council." United Nations. Francesca Albanese is an international human rights lawyer assigned by the United Nations to monitor human rights in occupied Palestine—the "UN Special Rapporteur on human rights in the Palestinian Occupied Territories." Her 27-page report concluded (like Whyte above) that Israel is committing genocide in Gaza under the camouflage of a self-defensive war with inevitable humanitarian consequences. "This report concludes that there are reasonable grounds to believe that the threshold indicating that Israel has committed genocide has been met. One of the key findings of the report is that the Israeli executive and military leadership and Israeli soldiers have intentionally distorted *jus in bello* principles, subverting their protective functions, in an attempt to legitimize genocidal violence against the Palestinian people."

***Khatib, Rasha, Martin McKee and Salim Yusuf. July 2024. "Counting the dead in Gaza: difficult but essential." *The Lancet* 404, no. 10449: 237-238.** This brief assessment in a reputable medical journal argues that about 186,000 people have died in Gaza by July 2024, amounting to about 7% of the total population. (President Trump—perhaps accidentally—appeared to reveal the high death toll in early 2025 by saying "1.7 or 1.8 million people" were alive in Gaza,[116] when 2.1 million lived before the invasion.)

Bartov, Omer. August 13, 2024. "As a former IDF soldier and historian of genocide, I was deeply disturbed by my recent visit to Israel." *The Guardian*. An op-ed by Bartov (mentioned earlier), who explains from his recent visits to Israel why Israeli society degraded to the same level as Nazi Germany. "It seemed to me that they had not only internalised a particular view that has become commonplace in Israel…but had also developed a way of thinking that I had observed many years ago when studying the conduct, worldview and self-perception of German army soldiers in the second world war. Having internalised certain views of the enemy – the Bolsheviks as *Untermenschen*; Hamas as human animals – and of the wider population as less than human and undeserving of rights, soldiers observing or perpetrating atrocities tend to ascribe them not to their own military, or to themselves, but to the enemy." Bartov also explains how the May 6 attack on Rafah caused him to finally affirm a genocide verdict.

***B'tselem. August 2024. "Welcome to Hell: The Israeli Prison System as a Network of Torture Camps."** A 118-page report by Israel's leading human rights organization. It goes into detail regarding Israel's prison/concentration camp system, where many Palestinians were tortured and killed. "Among the prisoners, both male and female, are physicians, academics, lawyers, students, children and political leaders. Some were jailed simply for expressing sympathy for the suffering of Palestinians. Others were taken into custody during military activity in the Gaza Strip, on the sole grounds that they came under the vague definition of 'men of fighting age.' Some were imprisoned over suspicions, substantiated or not, that they were operatives or supporters of armed Palestinian organizations. The prisoners form a wide spectrum

[116] Kevin Maimann, '1.7 million' Palestinians in Gaza? Trump's statement raises questions about death toll," *CBC News,* 13 February 2025

of people from different areas, with varying political opinions. The only thing they have in common is being Palestinian."

***Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights. September 20, 2024. "A/79/363: Report of the Special Committee to Investigate Israeli Practices Affecting the Human Rights of the Palestinian People and Other Arabs of the Occupied Territories." This 27-page report on Israeli treatment of Palestinians concludes that "The developments in this report lead the Special Committee to conclude that the policies and practices of Israel during the reporting period are consistent with the characteristics of genocide."

**Boisen, Camilla. September 24, 2024. "Israel's Punitive War Against Palestinians in Gaza." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1-22. Argues that Israel's ground invasion and bombing of Gaza is not a "just" or "defensive" war, but a punitive one. She writes that "genocide is a product of the punitive war theory tradition" and "Israel's arguments for the war in Gaza rely on an indiscriminate use between both defensive and offensive moral justifications for war."

***Euromed Human Rights Monitor. October 7, 2024. "De-Gaza: A Year of Israel's Genocide and the Collapse of the World Order." A 111-page report by a Geneva-based human rights organization (led by former Princeton professor and UN international lawyer, Richard Falk). It extensively documents Israel's genocide over the first year.

**Forensic Architecture. October 15, 2024. "A Spatial Analysis of the Israel Military's Conduct in Gaza Since October 2023." An 827-page report by a London-based research firm analytically and scientifically documents the IDF's genocidal destruction of civilian infrastructure in Gaza. The organization also provided a publicly-interactive model "Cartography of Genocide."[117]

**Goldberg, Amos. October 15, 2024. The Problematic Return of Intent. *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–10. Following up on his previous essay, the Professor of Holocaust Studies in Jerusalem compares Hitler's intent to Israeli intent of genocide and concludes: "What is happening in Gaza is a genocide, in my opinion, because the level and pace of indiscriminate killing, destruction, mass expulsion, displacement, deliberate famine, executions, the wiping out of universities, cultural and religious institutions, the crushing of elites (including the killing of journalists), and the sweeping dehumanization of the Palestinians create an overall picture of genocide, of the intentional and conscious shattering of Palestinian existence in Gaza. Palestinian Gaza, as a geographical, political, cultural, and human entity no longer exists. Genocide is the deliberate destruction of a collective or part of it, not of all of its individual members – and that is what is happening in Gaza today."

**Albanese, Francesca. October 24, 2024. "A report on the situation of human rights in the Palestinian territories occupied since 1967: Genocide as Colonial Erasure." A 32-page document by an international human rights lawyer covering the Gaza genocide in the context of settler colonialism. Albanese demonstrates that "While the scale and nature of the ongoing Israeli assault against the Palestinians vary by area, the totality of the Israeli acts of destruction directed against the totality of the Palestinian people, with the aim of conquering the totality of the land of Palestine, is clearly identifiable."

[117] See https://gaza.forensic-architecture.org/database.

***Amnesty International. November 5, 2024. "Israel/Occupied Palestinian Territory: 'You Feel Like You Are Subhuman': Israel's Genocide Against Palestinians in Gaza." A 296-page report by the leading international human rights organization. One of the most significant publications on the genocide.

**Al-Haq. November 7, 2024. "How to Hide a Genocide: The Role of Evacuation Orders and Safe Zones in Israel's Genocidal Campaign in Gaza." A 74-page report by a Palestinian human rights organization based in the occupied West Bank showing how "evacuations" constitute genocidal ethnic cleansing. (Compare to the "Trail of Tears" during western American expansion, "Long Walk" of the Navajo, or the 1915 death marches of the Armenian genocide). This confirms previous reports that "humanitarian efforts" on behalf of the IDF were in fact genocidal. This strategy became particularly vivid with the daily, systematic shooting of around 100 civilians at "aid sites" at the start of 2025.

***Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights. November 8, 2024. "Six-month update report on the human rights situation in Gaza: 1 November 2023 to 30 April 2024." This 31-page report documents war crimes (particularly, starvation used as a weapon of war) committed by the IDF's destructive campaign, revealing that over 70% of those killed were women and children. (The IDF's own figure of civilian deaths was a staggering 83% in August 2025[118]).[119]

**Human Rights Watch. November 14, 2024. "Hoping, Starving, and Besieged." Trailing on Amnesty's recent report and the report by Al-Haq, this 154-page report expands on the logistics and geography of the genocidal evacuation orders of the IDF in Gaza since October 7, 2024, though does not yet condemn Israel for genocide proper.

***European Center for Constitutional and Human Rights. December 16, 2024. "Gaza and the Matter of Genocide." This Berlin-based human rights and legal organization concludes in a 7-page statement that there is a sound legal basis for concluding the Israel is committing genocide in Gaza.

***Human Rights Watch. December 19, 2024. "Extermination and Acts of Genocide: Israel Deliberately Depriving Palestinians in Gaza of Water." Finally, after great delay, the HRW released its 179-page report condemning Israel's actions as genocide. It gives special attention to Israel's withholding of water and the intentional destruction of other conditions necessary for life.

*Airwars. December, 2024. "Patterns of Harm Analysis: Gaza October 2023." This UK-based international violence and war watchdog organization produced a 29-page report specifically examining the genocidal bombing campaign of Israel in Gaza the month that the assault began (October 2023). The total of 1,900 children killed by Israel in Gaza during this period was seven times the number killed in a single month in any other war the organization has studied.

**Médecins Sans Frontières. December, 2024. "Gaza: Life in a Death Trap." This 34-page report by Doctors Without Borders concludes that, based on what is happening at hospitals and with healthcare workers, Israel's actions are genocidal. They note that "Throughout the offensive, Israeli forces have blocked essential items such as food, water and medical supplies from entering the Strip. They have either

[118] Emma Graham-Harrison and Yuval Abraham, "Revealed: Israeli military's own data indicates civilian death rate of 83% in Gaza war," *The Guardian,* 21 August 2025.

[119] Note that at this point (November 11-12) the Gaza Genocide was listed at the top of Wikipedia's master list of genocides. In the same week, after months of avoidance and denial, the Prime Minister of Britain was publicly asked his definition of genocide and, despite being a human rights lawyer, he refused to answer. Rhiannon James, "Starmer resists pressure to describe war in Gaza as 'genocide'," *The Independent,* 13 November 2024.

denied, delayed or instrumentalized humanitarian assistance, allowing insignificant quantities of aid into Gaza with a complete disregard for the actual needs and the level of suffering of the population. Gaza's last remaining oncological hospital had to shut down as it ran out of fuel on 1 November 2023."

***Gordon, Neve. "Shields and the genocide in Gaza." *Radical Philosophy* 2, no. 17 (Winter 2024): 10–22.** An international legal scholar debunks the "Hamas uses human shields" justification for the IDF's genocidal actions.[120] (Israelis, ironically, are notorious for using Palestinians as "human shields."[121])

****Shatz, Omer. December 6, 2024. "Communication to the Prosecutor of the International Criminal Court Incitement to Genocide in Gaza Situation in the State of Palestine; ICC-01/18." Filing to the ICC.** A 170-page submission by an Israeli lawyer (Omer Shatz, faculty at Sciences Po, Paris) and counsel of the International Criminal Court. He accuses eight Israelis for incitement to genocide, which is notable since the legal charge of incitement can be independently prosecuted whether or not intent to commit genocide is proven.

[120] Note that Gordon co-authored a book on this general subject with Nicola Perugini entitled *Human Shields*: *A History of People in the Line of Fire* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 2020).

[121] Yaniv Kubovich and Michael Hauser Tov, "Haaretz Investigation: Israeli Army Uses Palestinian Civilians to Inspect Potentially Booby-trapped Tunnels in Gaza," *Haaretz,* 13 August 2024; Natan Odenheimer, Bilal Shbair, and Patrick Kingsley, "How Israel's Army Uses Palestinians as Human Shields," *The New York Times,* 14 October 2024; Sam Mednick and Samy Magdy, "Israeli use of human shields in Gaza was systematic, soldiers and former detainees tell the AP," *Associated Press,* 24 May 2025.

2.4. Section D: 2025

2025 continued the destruction and blockade of Gaza (and accelerated killings in the West Bank). The deaths from starvation increased dramatically, with the total death count approaching anywhere from 300,000-680,000.[122] And while there was much global protest, many warnings, words and public denouncements, Israel continued the complete destruction of Gaza relatively unaffected because of continued support by its western allies—primarily the United States and Britain. Since 2023, only Hamas fighters and the Houthis of Yemen attempted to directly disable the IDF by force of arms. Campaigns of BDS (Boycott, Divestment, and Sanctions) achieved several victories—divestment from wealth funds and boycotts,[123] dock workers refusing to service ships carrying arms to Israel,[124] city governments disassociating with Israel,[125] over a thousand filmmakers boycotting Israel[126] followed by musical artists,[127] an attempted boycott of Israel from Eurovision,[128] a flotilla of aid with 497 people from 46 countries sailing across the Mediterranean,[129] and hundreds of IDF reservists also refused to serve.[130] The Palestinian flag flew over the city hall of Rome on September 21, 2025 in solidarity, as in other cities. Anti-genocide marches crowded Tel Aviv in August 2025,[131] as in other cities. However, none of this was enough to end Israel's campaign of conquering and permanently open the gates of aid. By October, the IDF conquered nearly a third of Gaza represented by the north-south "yellow line"; those who approached were threatened or shot.[132]

Meanwhile, the Israel lobby in the United States wielded enormous efforts to stifle dissent and shore up support.[133] For example, Columbia University expelled students who protested the genocide,[134] adopted the IHRA definition of antisemitism (which prohibits criticism of Israel),[135] and revamped its Middle East

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[122] Richard Hil and Gideon Polya, "Skewering History: The Odious Politics of Counting Gaza's Dead," *Arena,* 11 July 2025. Israelis admitted over 200,000 casualties in October, 2025. See Julian Borger, "'We took the gloves off': ex-IDF chief confirms Gaza casualties over 200,000," *The Guardian,* 12 September 2025.
[123] E.g., AP, "Norway's sovereign wealth fund sells its shares in 11 Israeli companies," *Associated Press,* 11 August 2025; Reuters, "Danish pension fund drops Israeli investments over human rights concerns," *Reuters,* 24 September, 2025.
[124] E.g., Rafeef Ziadah and Katy Fox-Hodess, "European Dockworkers Refuse to Load Weapons Aimed at Palestine," *Labor Notes,* 12 June 2025; RFI staff, "French dockers refuse to load cargo of machine gun parts bound for Israel," *RFI,* 5 June 2025; Ana Vračar, "Athens dockworkers obstruct military cargo shipment to Israel," *People's Dispatch,* 14 July 2025; Alex Laguna, "Genoa Port Workers Block Passage Of Saudi Ship Carrying Weapons For Israel," *World Ports Org,* 11 August 2025.
[125] E.g., Ryan Hansen, "Iowa City OKs resolution to boycott companies 'complicit' in Gaza's 'humanitarian crisis'," *Iowa City Press-Citizen,* 6 August 2025.
[126] Casey Cooper-Fiske, "Hollywood actors refusing to work with Israeli companies 'implicated in genocide'," *The Independent*, 8 September 2025.
[127] Shay Ringel, "Over 400 International Artists Sign a Petition to Remove Their Songs From Platforms in Israel," *Times of Israel,* 19 September 2025.
[128] Ellen O'Regan, "Crisis engulfs Eurovision over Israel and Gaza," *Politico,* 17 September 2025.
[129] Reuters staff, "Israeli military stops nearly all boats in aid flotilla, sparking global protests," *Reuters,* 3 October 2025.
[130] Bar Peleg and Yaniv Kubovich, "Hundreds of IDF Reservists Sign Statement Opposing Gaza City Takeover, Saying They Won't Report to Duty," *Haaretz,* 2 September 2025.
[131] Deiaa Haj Yahia, "'Stop the Genocide': Thousands of Jews and Arabs Rally in Tel Aviv Against Gaza War, Hunger," *Haaretz,* 23 August 2025.
[132] Stephen N. R., "Yellow Line in Gaza: From truce zone to kill zone — How a ceasefire boundary turned deadly," *Gulf News,* 21 October 2025.
[133] On this general subject, see Ilan Pappe, *Lobbying for Zionism: On Both Sides of the Atlantic* (New York: Oneworld, 2024); John Mearsheimer and Stephen Walt, *The Israel Lobby* (New York: Farrar, Straus and Giroux, 2007); Finkelstein, *The Holocaust Industry.*
[134] AP, "Columbia University says it has suspended and expelled students who participated in protests," *Associated Press,* 22 July 2025.
[135] Ryan Quinn, "Columbia 'Incorporating' IHRA Antisemitism Definition," *Inside Higher Ed,* 17 July 2025.

studies department.[136] Netanyahu was hosted at the Capitol over congressional recess,[137] a record fifty American politicians were escorted to Israel at once,[138] tourists and foreigners who criticized Israel on social media were threatened with deportation,[139] visas of Palestinians or those publicly opposed to the genocide of Palestinians were canceled,[140] the courts moved to penalize Americans who might harm the Israeli flag,[141] media and media moderators were directly bought out,[142] and so forth. The U.S. issued new sanctions on additional ICC judges and prosecutors for prosecuting Israel[143] and used its immigrations enforcement division (ICE) to crack down on anti-Israel protestors and activists,[144] while Britain arrested over a thousand on charges of "terrorism" for publicly supporting a Palestine activist organization.[145] The EU failed to implement sanctions, the Dutch Foreign Minister and others "resigned after failing to secure cabinet support for additional sanctions against Israel over its military onslaught in Gaza,"[146] though Spain and Scotland succeeded in imposing a boycott and/or sanctions against Israel.[147]

Verdeja, Ernesto. January 20, 2025. "The Gaza Genocide in Five Crises." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–23. Given the widespread acknowledgement of genocide by this time, the question of "how?" entered many minds. This article by a political scientist and specialist on genocide explains how the Gaza genocide happened and how it affected different areas in "five crises: the crisis in the Palestinian Occupied Territories, particularly Gaza; in Genocide and Holocaust studies; in international law; in the United Nations' (UN) responsibility to protect norm; and in international multilateral atrocity prevention efforts."

***Dunkelberg, Gurmendi, Alonso. January 22, 2025. "How to Hide a Genocide: Modern/Colonial International Law and the Construction of Impunity." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–24.** A

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[136] Jake Offerhartz, "Under threat from Trump, Columbia University agrees to policy changes," *Associated Press*, 21 March 2025.
[137] Nava Freiberg, "Netanyahu briefs visiting members of US Congress on Gaza war," *Times of Israel,* 6 August 2025.
[138] Amichai Stein, "Bipartisan US support reminds Israel that true friends stand by us, official tells 'Post'," *Jerusalem Post,* 15 September 2025. This was "the largest-ever US delegation of lawmakers" in Israel.
[139] Judy Lucas, "Cornell grad student sues Trump administration to stop targeted deportation efforts," *The Ithaca Voice,* 18 March 2025; Sharon Zhang, "DHS Announces It's Surveilling Immigrants' Social Media for 'Antisemitism'," *Truthout,* 9 April 2025.
[140] Andrea Shalal and Susan Heavey, "Trump administration to cancel student visas of pro-Palestinian protesters," *Reuters,* 29 January 2025; Mathew Lee, "Trump administration restrictions on Palestinian visa applicants means nearly all would be refused," *Associated Press,* 2 September 2025.
[141] Luke Tress, "Legal group hails breakthrough as US judge equates Israeli flag with Jewish identity," *Times of Israel,* 14 August 2025.
[142] Helskini Times staff, "Google in $45 million deal with Israel to deny Gaza famine, report claims," *Helsinki Times,* 6 September 2025; Middle East Eye staff, " TikTok hires ex-Israeli army instructor as new hate speech manager, sparking backlash," *Middle East Eye*, 29 July 2025; Jack Mirkinson, "Vile Grifters Are Taking Over Establishment Media," *The Nation,* 4 September 2025; The Independent staff, "'He lied to us': CBS News staffers say new owner David Ellison 'just can't be trusted'," *The Independent,* 16 September 2025; TRT staff, "Netanyahu admits using social media to sway US opinion amid Gaza genocide," *TRT World,* 27 September 2025; Zvika Klein, "Editor's Notes: After Charlie Kirk's warning, Israel bets on Gen Z influencers – comment," *Jerusalem Post,* 3 October 2025.
[143] International Criminal Court, "The ICC strongly rejects new US sanctions against Judges and Deputy Prosecutors," 20 August 2025, https://www.icc-cpi.int/news/icc-strongly-rejects-new-us-sanctions-against-judges-and-deputy-prosecutors.
[144] Jake OffernHartz, "Immigration agents arrest Palestinian activist who helped lead Columbia University protests," *Associated Press,* 9 March 2025; AP staff, "A look at the people ensnared in Trump's campaign against pro-Palestinian activism at US colleges," *Associated Press,* 1 April 2025.
[145] Sammy Gecsoyler and Donna Ferguson, "Police arrest 474 people at protest over Palestine Action ban in London," *The Guardian,* 9 August 2025; Josh Gabert-Doyon, "Met police arrest almost 900 people at Palestine Action protest," *Financial Times,* 7 September 2025.
[146] Al Jazeera staff, "Dutch foreign minister resigns over Israel sanctions deadlock," *Al Jazeera,* 22 August 2025.
[147] Escarlata Sánchez & Maria Muñoz Morillo, "Spain increases humanitarian aid for Gaza and imposes arms embargo on Israel," *Euronews,* 8 September 2025; Steph Brown, "Scottish Parliament votes for immediate boycott of Israel," *The National,* 3 September 2025.

sociologist and scholar of war and international law argues that genocide is actually quite common throughout history, not a rare event requiring extraordinary analysis and judgment. Similar to the work of Moses, Dunkelberg contends that "the conventional concept of genocide, as well as its subsequent interpretation, has been constructed to uphold the impunity of criminal modernity/coloniality." He gives particular attention to the Gaza genocide among others, showing how international law and "interpretive inventions such as the 'purpose-based' notion of intent and the 'only reasonable inference" standard…rendered the concept of genocide useless for the modern age."

***South Africa. February 4, 2025. "Public dossier of openly available evidence on the State of Israel's acts of genocide against the Palestinians in Gaza, as of 4 February 2025." To the Security Council of United Nations.** This 227-page document by South Africa's legal representatives compiles evidence of genocide into the second month of 2025. It is perhaps the most well-documented legal publication of Israel's genocide up to that point in time.

****Sorek, Tamir. February 6, 2025. "Mainstreaming a Genocidal Imagination in Israeli Society: Settler-Colonialism, Settler Anxiety, and Biblical Cues." *Journal of Genocide Research*, February, 1–24.** In a work exploring the "how" question, this article demonstrates how genocidal attitudes became popular in Israeli society and Zionist circles by way of three areas: settler colonialism and the long-term plan of transferring the native population; the psychology of "permanent security"; and biblical holy land theology.

****Segal, Raz. February 24, 2025. "Israeli Settler Colonial Genocide, *The Journal of Imperial and Commonwealth History*, 53, no.1, 182-191**. A straightforward summary by a leading genocide scholar showing how the genocide in Gaza (and its western support) is the result of Jewish white-supremacist ideas and American settler colonialism.

***Odeh, Tayseer Abu, and Shahd Dibas. March 2, 2025. "Zionist Settler-Colonialism and the Logic of Genocide in Gaza: A Conversation with Professor Avi Shlaim." *Journal of Holy Land and Palestine Studies* 24, no. 1.** This interaction with Shlaim provides an accessible overview of how settler colonialism results in genocide, and how Israel, as a European Zionist nationalist project and apartheid state that seeks geographical expansion, is no exception.

****Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights: Independent International Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and Israel. March 13, 15, 2025. "'More than a human can bear': Israel's systematic use of sexual, reproductive and other forms of gender-based violence since 7 October 2023."** By this time, it was well-known the IDF was sexually-assaulting Palestinians while in custody (especially at the notorious Sde Teiman facility). One physician, Dr. Adnan al Bursh, was tortured and "likely raped to death."[148] Videos of another gang rape were leaked to the public in autumn of 2024, and riots in Israel broke out after several IDF members faced charges for the act.[149] This internal division prompted fierce debate in the Knesset over what essentially amounted to the

[148] John Sparks, "'He was the light of my life and I lost him': How a famous surgeon died in an Israeli prison after being taken from Gaza hospital," *SkyNews,* 14 November 2024; Jerusalem Post staff, "Francesca Albanese alleges Palestinian doctor 'likely raped to death' in Israeli detention," *Jerusalem Post,* 18 November 2024.
[149] Alisha Rahaman Sarkar, "Israeli protesters storm military base after soldiers held over Palestinian prisoner abuse," *The Independent,* 30 July 2024; Simon Speakman Cordall, "'Everything is legitimate': Israeli leaders defend soldiers accused of rape," *Al Jazeera,* 9 August 2024.

right-to-rape Palestinian prisoners.[150] This detailed 49-page report documents Israel's regular use of sexual abuse in its genocide against Palestinians and occupation of Palestine, also exploring the logic and purpose of such domination strategies. It vividly demonstrates the dehumanization of Palestinians as a group.

****LeVine, Mark and Eric Cheyfitz. April 22, 2025. "Israel, Palestine, and the Poetics of Genocide Revisited." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–23.** Shows how the Gaza invasion fits the standard legal definition of genocide, but offers a newly revised definition of genocide that accounts for colonialism and the destruction of the Palestinian people. In their words, "genocide has followed a serpentine, multi-locational, and longer durée in Israel/Palestine than the 1948 Convention allows. The complexity and duration of destruction in and of Palestine demands a precise analysis of the experiences and imaginations of, and relationships between, victims and perpetrators alike as actors in the larger drama of violence across nearly a century-and-a-half of conflict."

***Hamamra, Bilal, Fayez Mahamid and Dana Bdier. May 6, 2025. "Surviving Trauma: Gazan Women's Mental Health During Genocide." *Discover Public Health* 2, no. 229.** An analytical study of women in Gaza during the genocide. "The findings highlight the detrimental effects of the Israeli destruction of Gazan healthcare, food shortages, and displacement on women's mental health, compounded by gender-based violence and loss of privacy and dignity. Despite these traumatic challenges, the article highlights the resilience of Gazan women, shaped by social support and cultural practices."

****Shlaim, Avi. May 6, 2025. *Genocide in Gaza: Israel, Hamas, and the Long War on Palestine*. Belfast: Irish Pages Press**. One of the first major books on the Gaza genocide, which includes a foreword from Francesca Albanese and a statement by Blinne Ní Ghrálaigh KC from January 2024 to the ICJ (Counsel and Advocate for South Africa in the Case of Genocide against Israel). In this collection of accessible essays, Shlaim argues that the Gaza genocide is the natural outcome of Israel as a settler colonial project and ethnostate.

***Van Laarhoven, Kasper, Eva Peek, and Derk Walters. May 14, 2025. "Seven renowned scientists almost united: Israel commits genocide in Gaza." *NRC*.** A Dutch newspaper investigated articles from the *Journal of Genocide Research* and found that all seven leading genocide experts agree Israel was committing genocide in Gaza. (They include researchers mentioned in this bibliography as well as Iva Vukusic, professor in the History of International Relations and war crimes specialist at Utrecht University).

***Veracini, Lorenzo. May 17, 2025. "Genocide in Gaza and the End of Settler Colonialism." *The Journal of Imperial and Commonwealth History*.** A leading scholar on colonialism agrees with others that Israel is a genocidal settler colony, but challenges the idea that the Gaza genocide is its culmination and apex. On the contrary, the genocide demonstrates its failure: "A settler colonial regime that returns to its murderous origins and abandons structural modes of oppression is destructuring itself…The onslaught on Gaza undermines the possibility of fulfilling settler colonialism by way of a demographic takeover. Not only Israel has failed in recent decades to attract substantial cohorts of new Jewish immigrants – many are now choosing to leave."

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[150] Debora Patta and Tucker Reals, "Israeli lawmaker defends alleged rape of Hamas prisoner as far-right protesters rage over IDF troops' detention," *CBS News,* 30 July 2024. Cf. Joseph Massad, "Why raping Palestinians is legitimate Israeli practice," *Middle East Eye,* 12 August 2024; Oren Ziv, "A riote for impunity shows Israel's proud embrace of its crimes," *+972 Magazine,* 1 August 2024; Jonathan Ofir, "The main suspect in the Sde Teiman gang rape case is now a media star in Israel," *Mondoweiss,* 28 August 2024.

Omer, Atalia. May 22, 2025. "Turning Palestine into a *Terra Nullius*: On Amalek and "Miracles." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–22. A scholar on religious and cultural conflict (Professor of Religion, Conflict, and Peace Studies, University of Notre Dame) explains how the Israeli use of the Hebrew Bible has (or hasn't) been used to justify their genocide in Gaza. She specifically explains how "the rhetorical use of Amalek as a racialized ethnoreligious discourse reflects the operative force of Judeo-Christian (neo)colonial secularity."

Sumption, Rt. Honorable Lord et. al. May 26, 2024 (updated to May 2025). "UK Judges' and Lawyers' Open Letter Concerning the Occupied Palestinian Territory – May 2025." London. A 37-page letter by 1,138 judges, lawyers, and law professors in the United Kingdom. The authors write about "deep concern over the worsening catastrophe in the occupied Palestinian territory ('oPt', Gaza, the West Bank and East Jerusalem) and our commitment to upholding the rule of law. Serious violations of international law are being committed and are further threatened by Israel in the oPt. First, genocide is being perpetrated in Gaza or, at a minimum, there is a serious risk of genocide occurring. Second, war crimes, crimes against humanity, and serious violations of international humanitarian law are being committed in the oPt. Third, Israel has been found by the International Court of Justice in July 2024 to be violating peremptory norms of international law across the entire oPt in denying the Palestinian people their right to self-determination and unlawfully annexing territory acquired by force."

Barigye, Yvonne Natasha, Melissa Hendrickse, and Vito Todeschini. May 26, 2025. "Genocidal Intent in Armed Conflict: Unpacking the ICJ's 'Only Reasonable Inference' Standard." *OpinioJuris*. Three legal scholars show that the fact that Israel's genocide in Gaza is happening in the context of armed military conflict should not obscure its genocidal nature. (Most genocides happen in the context of war.)

Hassoun, Abdo (ed.). May 31, 2025. *War in Gaza: Consequences on Sustainability and Global Security*. Cham: Palgrave MacMillan. A major book on the Gaza genocide with multiple authors that uses the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to show various dimensions of ecological destruction, social inequality, famine, destruction of housing, economy, etc. Incorporating the SDG framework provides an unusually comprehensive perspective regarding the totality and existential nature of Israel's destructive campaign.

*Gaarb, Yaakov. June 3, 2025. "The Israeli/American/GHF 'aid distribution' compounds in Gaza: Dataset and initial analysis of location, context, and internal structure." Harvard Dataverse.** Made by a professor at Ben-Gurion University (Israel), this research model indicates that Israel is causing starvation and needless death in Gaza, and that around 377,000 people were missing in Gaza.

Lambos, Kai, and Stephanie Bock. June 4, 2025. "Genocide in Gaza?" *Verfassungsblog*. Lambos (Professor of Criminal and International Law at the University of Göttingen, a Judge at the Kosovo Specialist Chambers in The Hague) and Bock (Professor of Criminal Law, Criminal Procedure, International Criminal Law and Comparative Law and the Executive Director of the International Research and Documentation Centre for War Crimes Trials at the University of Marburg) are two European legal scholars who conclude that "on the whole, the dynamics of the conflict now speak more in favour of genocide than against it. In this context, it bears noting that the intent to destroy need not be the sole motive of the perpetrator or the collective entity allegedly pursuing a genocide. Instead, a genocidal intent may well coincide with other motives, e.g. certain military objectives or security policy considerations."

*Lederman, Zohar, Anne Irfan, and Shmuel Lederman. June 16, 2025. "Is it Genocide? Yes It Is—A Response to Paul James." *Bioethical Inquiry* 22, no. 2. A refutation of the claim (in *Bioethical Inquiry* 22, no.1) that the Gaza genocide is actually just a terrible war. Authors include scholars from Hong Kong, Israel, and London.

**Albanese, Francesca. June 16, 2025. "Report of the Special Rapporteur on the situation of human rights in the Palestinian territories occupied since 1967: From economy of occupation to economy of genocide ." Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights. Documents the major corporate participants in the Gaza genocide. This publication proved particularly controversial since it named the companies complicit in the genocide (such as Google, Amazon, Microsoft, IBM, Palantir, Chevron, BP, Hyundai, etc.) and showed the economic infrastructure that made Israeli's high-tech, AI-supported genocide possible.

**European External Action Service (EEAS). June 20, 2025. "Note of the Office of the EU Special Representative for Human Rights." European Union. An 8-page internal documented shared within the EU, signaling that Israel is in breach of human rights. Despite this notice, and despite the well-documented war crimes, atrocities, and genocide perpetrated by Israel by this time, the EU failed to suspend their association agreement with Israel in a meeting of the foreign ministers in Brussels on July 15, 2025. Amnesty International's Secretary General said "This will be remembered as one of the most disgraceful moments in the EU's history."[151]

**Defense for Children International: Palestine. June 24, 2025. "Starving a Generation: Israel's Famine Campaign Targeting Palestinian Children in Gaza." Written by a section of the legal organization Defense for Children International (DCI), this 26-page report reviews Israel's specific attacks and destruction of Palestinian children. One of their five conclusions is "Refusal by the international community to declare famine, acknowledge Israeli officials' genocidal intent, and break Israel's siege has paved the way for the starvation of more children."

**Badarin, Emile. June 26, 2025. Recognition Politics in Settler Colonial States: Normalizing Dispossession and Elimination in Palestine (Unsettling Colonialism in our Times). London: I. B. Tauris. A Palestinian scholar (mentioned earlier) explains more fully how the two-state solution and recognition of Palestine only normalizes the colonialism and genocide of Palestinians. Also addresses the conflation of anti-Zionism with antisemitism.

*Bartov, Omer. July 15, 2025. "I'm a Genocide Scholar. I know it When I See It." *The New York Times.* Bartov explains in one of the most popular newspapers in the world how Israel is committing genocide.

***B'tSelem. July 28, 2025. "Our Genocide." Israel's leading human rights organization finally condemns Israel's genocide as a genocide in an 88-page report. While the report follows the legal framework of genocide and summarizes a cogent case, its treatment is somewhat cursory and does not seriously engage the historical and cultural context or the genocidal intent to destroy. This is likely due to being a late-comer that relies on previous reports, and also because it tries to make sense of the genocide through a liberal Zionist lens of Israeli society. This creates a variety of tensions—including the baffling first sentence: "Since

[151] Amnesty International, "EU-Israel: Refusal to suspend the EU-Israel Association Agreement is a 'cruel and unlawful betrayal'," *Amnesty International,* 15 July 2025, https://www.amnesty.org/en/latest/news/2025/07/eu-israel-refusal-to-suspend-the-eu-israel-association-agreement-is-a-cruel-and-unlawful-betrayal/

October 2023, Israel has fundamentally changed its policy toward the Palestinians."[152] (See "Before October 7, 2023" above for a refutation). Nevertheless, it was received like a shockwave in certain circles of Israeli society, and anti-genocide (not simply anti-Netanyahu or anti-war) protests became more common in Tel Aviv and Jerusalem.

****Physicians for Human Rights. July, 2025. "Destruction of the Conditions for Life: A Health Analysis of the Gaza Genocide."** Released in the same week as "Our Genocide" (see above), this medical Israeli human rights organization focuses on how the targeted destruction of Gaza's healthcare system and other conditions for life specifically meets the third condition for the legal definition of genocide, "(c) Deliberately inflicting on the group conditions of life calculated to bring about its physical destruction in whole or in part."

****O'Brien, Melanie. August 4, 2025. "Is Genocide Happening in Gaza?" *OpinioJuris*.** O'Brien (faculty of international law at the University of Western Australia, President of the International Association of Genocide Scholars, and Visiting Scholar with the Human Rights Center at the University of Minnesota Law School) summarizes the situation in Gaza and concludes: "it is without a doubt that we are witnessing a genocide now in Gaza, and state parties to the Genocide Convention are failing in their obligation to prevent and punish genocide."

***Achcar, Gilbert. August 5, 2025. *Gaza Catastrophe: The Genocide in World-Historical Perspective.* Berkeley: University of California Press.** A scholar on international relations and development shows in an academic monograph that the Gaza genocide is not a random or historically insignificant event, but evidence that the modern "international liberal order" is bankrupt morally, materially, and intellectually.

****Médecins Sans Frontières. August 7, 2025. "This is not Aid. This is Orchestrated Killing: MSF's frontline medical testimony on systematic mass casualties from GHF sites in Gaza."**. This 26-page report demonstrates that the IDF are indiscriminately shooting Palestinians, including starving civilians waiting in line for food, children in the streets pursuing food, medical workers, and otherwise. The nefarious "Gaza Humanitarian Foundation" aid sites functioned as death traps.[153] "The 1,380 casualties received by MSF staff in our health centres are only a fraction of the total number of casualties from GHF distribution sites." The General Director recounts: "Children shot in the chest while reaching for food. People crushed or suffocated in stampedes. Entire crowds gunned down at distribution points. In MSF's 54 years of operations, rarely have we seen such levels of systematised violence against an unarmed civilian population, while masquerading s 'aid'. The GHF distribution sites have morphed into a cruelty lab."[154]

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[152] Cf. Jay Michaelson, "We must face reality — the Gaza war is now a war of annihilation," *Forward,* May 28, 2025: "Obviously, what has changed is the Israeli government's policy. No longer is this war being carried out to free the remaining hostages and defeat Hamas. Now, the stated goal is to exile or eliminate the Palestinian population of Gaza."

[153] The Foundation's security team was operated by Infidel, the Islamophobic biker gang. Andy Verity, Tom Beal & Will Dahlgreen, "Anti-Islamic US biker gang members run security at deadly Gaza aid sites," *BBC,* 9 September 2025.

[154] These reflections are similar to Pulitzer-Prize winning journalist Chris Hedges after covering the IDF's earlier operations in Gaza: "Children have been shot in other conflicts I have covered—death squads gunned them down in El Salvador and Guatemala, mothers with infants were lined up and massacred in Algeria, and Serb snipers put children in their sights and watched them crumple onto the pavement in Sarajevo—but I have never before watched soldiers entice children like mice into a trap and murder them for sport." Chris Hedges, "A Gaza Diary," *Harper's Magazine* (October 2001): 59-71, at 64.

Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights. August 7 2025. "Gaza: 'Never again,' giving way to endless decimation of displaced Palestinians, warn UN experts." Five scholars (in areas of law, food security, human rights) decry Israel's continued genocide in this press release.

de Frouville, Olivier and Julian Fernandez. August 8. 2025. "Palestine: ce qui unit les jurists [Palestine: What Unites the Lawyers]." *Ledevoir*. An open letter by 160 professors of law condemning Israeli's war crimes and genocide. They argue that genocidal intent is clear with regard to the actions of the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation, and that "questions about the classification of 'genocide' cannot be used to try to minimize the seriousness of the crimes committed, or the seriousness of the other qualifications that no longer make any debate" (translated from French).

***Pillay, Navi. August 14, 2025. "Report of the Independent International Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and Israel."** A 22-page report to the United Nations General Assembly concludes that "the State of Israel is responsible for the commission of four genocidal acts in Gaza with the specific intent to destroy Palestinians in Gaza, as such" and that "The Commission also found that the Israeli President, Prime Minister and former Defence Minister have incited the commission of genocide."

***Irfan, Anne. August 24, 2025. "Settler Colonialism and the Displacement/Immobility Nexus: Israeli Policy in Gaza Since 1948." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–17**. Israel is known for continually displacing Palestinians while also trapping them physically and legally into various corners. This article by a a scholar on forced migration (Lecturer in Interdisciplinary Race, Gender and Postcolonial Studies, University College London) argues "that while forced migration and containment may appear to exist in opposition to one another – one concerns the right to move, the other the right not to move – they are more accurately understood as functioning in tandem. Indeed, these two categories are flip sides of the same coin, which I describe here as the displacement/immobility nexus."

***Oxfam. Updated to August 29. 2025. "What's Happening in Gaza?"** This brief report summarizes the situation in Gaza, and clarifies that it "refers to Israel's actions in Gaza as genocide following a rigorous legal assessment and consultation with experts, grounded in the UN Genocide Convention." The August version also says "Oxfam condemns the actions of Hamas and other armed Palestinian groups," which is puzzling since the right to resist invaders, defend sovereignty, and resist extermination is also recognized by international law.[155] (It was during this time that Israel's continued "negotiations" with Hamas[156] forcefully demanded their disarmament.[157] The default pro-Israel orientation had become so ingrained in the public

[155] Protocol Additional to the Geneva Conventions of 12 August 1949, and relating to the Protection of Victims of International Armed Conflicts (Protocol I), 8 June 1977, 1125 U.N.T.S. 3. Cf. United Nations General Assembly, "Declaration on the Granting of Independence to Colonial Countries and Peoples," Resolution 1514 (XV), December 14, 1960; "Declaration on Principles of International Law concerning Friendly Relations and Co-operation among States in Accordance with the Charter of the United Nations," Resolution 2625 (XXV), October 24, 1970; "Basic principles of the legal status of the combatants struggling against colonial and alien domination and racist regimes," Resolution 3103 (XXVIII), December 12, 1973.
[156] Israel killed the hostage negotiator Osama Mazini on October 16, 2023, and then killed the negotiator Ismail Haniyeh in Iran on July 31, 2024.
[157] Jeremy Scahill and Jawa Ahmad, "Exclusive: Hamas Offered Major Concessions in New Gaza Ceasefire Proposal," *Drop Site News,* 21 August 2025, https://www.dropsitenews.com/p/hamas-israel-gaza-ceasefire-concessions-negotiations-netanyahu-trump.

consciousness that the idea of forcefully *disarming the perpetrator* of genocide was considered unthinkable—even to human rights organizations. Oxfam later changed this sentence.[158])

***European Center for Populism Studies. August 30, 2025. "Professor Schabas: US, Germany, and Others Could be Held Liable as Accomplices to Genocide in Gaza." Interview by Selcuk Gultasli.** Leading genocide and criminal law scholar William Schabas (mentioned earlier) explains the repercussions of supporting Israel's genocide. He draws attention to Israeli racism, and compares the indigenous rebellion against Germany's colonial rule (instigating the Namibia genocide) to the indigenous Palestinian revolt against Israel's colonial rule (instigating the Gaza genocide).

***International Association of Genocide Scholars. August 31, 2025. "IAGS Resolution on the Situation on Gaza."** A leading organization on genocide research, comprised of 500 members, passed a resolution of four-pages that condemns the Gaza genocide. The vote was 108-18-3 (totaling 129 votes and 28% voter participation, exceeding the 20% + 1 quorum requirement). The resolution contains cited links to evidence for all of its statements, and ends with two declarations and five calls for action.[159]

Special Committee to Investigate Israeli Practices Affecting the Human Rights of the Palestinian People and Other Arabs of the Occupied Territories. 5 September 2025. "Report of the Special Committee." A 24-page document demonstrating Israel's intention and actions in conquering more of the Middle East. It includes a section on the "Ongoing genocide of Palestinians in the Gaza Strip." The Committee was also "shocked by the extend of land confiscation, targeting of communities, separation of families, demolitions, forced evictions, killings, physical abuse, and other tactics" against Palestinians in the West Bank. The Committee argues that "Greater Israel" makes it "apparent that settler-colonialism is a key feature of the Israeli State."

****McGahern, Una. September 11, 2025. "The Practice of Siege Warfare: Reckoning with War, Genocide and Settler Colonialism in Palestine." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–22.** An ethnographer and scholar of political science (Senior Lecturer of Political Science at Newcastle University) explains the relationship between war, genocide, and colonialism to explain the Gaza genocide.

*****Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights: Independent International Commission Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem, and Israel. September 16, 2025. "Legal analysis of the conduct of Israel in Gaza pursuant to the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide."** A 72-page report authored by three international legal scholars and specialists on Palestine and Israel. They conclude that Israel has failed to prevent genocide, has committed genocide, and failed to punish those who committed genocide according to the official Genocide Convention criteria.

***Armed Conflict Location & Event Data. September 17, 2025. "Gaza after two years: As Israel expands control and sows chaos, Hamas adapts to survive."** Published by an independent data-reporting agency on armed conflicts, this brief report indicates that around 94% of those killed in Gaza since the March 18

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[158] For their October 10 update, Oxfam revised (and improved) the this portion to say, "Oxfam condemns the attacks and the taking of hostages by Hamas and other armed Palestinian groups on 7 October 2023, which amount to crimes against humanity and war crimes."

[159] While this was one of many such documents since October 2023, for one reason or another it gained tremendous publicity—prompting dissenters to quickly author and establish scholarsforgenocidetruth.com days later.

ceasefire were civilians. Also debunks the "Hamas is stealing aid" argument, and demonstrates the aid looting surged when the U.S.-backed Gaza Humanitarian Foundation began operating.

Gerntholtz, Liesl. September 18, 2025. "All That is Lost." *PEN America. A report documenting the extensive destruction of Palestinian culture in Gaza. Authored by the managing editor of PEN/Barbey Freedom to Write Center, who is also a South African human rights lawyer.

****McDoom, Omar Shahabudin. September 18, 2025. "It's Hamas' Fault, You're an Antisemite, and We Had No Choice: Techniques of Genocide Denial in Gaza." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–18**. Explores how antisemitism has been weaponized to justify Israel's genocide.

****Samudzi, Zoe. September 18, 2025. "Echolalias of Famine: Gaza after Biafra." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–17.** A scholar on African American studies and genocide explores the connections between colonial thought, racism and Israel's genocidal famine in Gaza.

****LeVine, Mark. September 18, 2025. "Epilogue: The 116-Year War on Palestine." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–11.** The Professor and Chair of the Program in Global Middle East Studies at the School of Humanities (University of California, Irvine) explains how Zionism has always been genocidal.

****Moses, A. Dirk. September 19, 2025. "Introduction: Gaza and the Problems of Genocide." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1-14.** The editor-in-chief of *Journal of Genocide Research* provides an enlightening introduction to the proceedings of a New York workshop on the Gaza genocide in 2025. Moses concisely identifies the various reasons why genocide scholars have or haven't condemned Israel's actions in Gaza as genocide, and how such hairsplitting ends up legitimizing the destruction of entire societies.

****Shalhoub-Kevorkiana, Nadera. September 19, 2025. "Five Pillars of Zionist Genocidal Apparatus: A Palestinian Problematization of Genocide Studies." *Journal of Genocide Studies*, 1-13.** An eye-opening and frank discussion about the problem of Gaza and genocide studies by a leading Palestinian legal scholar and social scientist (former Global Chair in Law at Queen Mary University of London and Lawrence D. Biele Chair in Law at Hebrew University of Jerusalem). She frames the Gaza genocide as resting on the five pillars of religious fundamentalism ("Ontotheological Amalekite Pillar), legal compromises ("crumbling of the international legal order"), the "necropolitical annihilatory enfleshed pillar" (culture of death), western capitalism, and the "psycho-aesthetic and rhetoric of horror and monstrosity pillar" (culture of digital, sensational conquering).

***Boulos, Sonia. September 19, 2025. "The 'G Word,' Liberal Israeli Elites, and the Prospect of Decolonization." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–21.** A legal scholar from Spain looks at how and why liberals accommodated to Israel's genocide in Gaza, and what is required to actually be anti-genocide.

****Shaw, Martin. September 19. 2025. "The Genocide That Changed the World." *Journal of Genocide Research* (September 2025), 1-15.** A leading genocide scholar explains why the Gaza genocide is so significant.

****Lederman, Schmuel. September 19, 2025. "A Not So Textbook Case of Genocide." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–12.** An Israeli holocaust scholar and historian explains legal reasoning regarding the Gaza genocide case at the ICJ, and (like Moses in the same publication) indicates that narrow technicalities leads to problems, and so rethinking the definition is necessary. "If Gaza is a textbook case in some fashion," he concludes, "it is not so much in the way it is supposedly unproblematically fits the legal

definition of genocide even in the more narrow interpretations of it, but rather in the way a society can be destroyed by a state that is so dependent on external military, economic, and political support that the genocide could quite easily be prevented or stopped, as we had before in East Timor, Congo, Yemen and elsewhere."

***Masharqa, Saleh. October 5, 2025. "Gazan Digital Storytellers: Popular Micronarratives Confronting Genocide." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–24.** A Palestinian expert on media studies explores the role of digital media creators during the genocide. In studying three particular creators, he shows how "The genocide in Gaza sparked an explosion of digital storytellers, thanks to the massive outpouring of empathy from millions of people worldwide. This was not merely a fleeting feeling; it was expressed through likes, comments, shares, and a genuine desire to connect with Gazan activists. As a result of witnessing this incredible global solidarity, dozens of these digital voices started refining their videos and translating them into countless languages to reach an even wider audience."

****Qandeel, Mais, and Topak, Özgün Erdener. (2025). Genocidal Surveillant Assemblage in Palestine: A Socio-Legal Analysis. *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–22.** A lawyer and international legal professor with a focus on Palestine (Mais Qandeel, Associate Professor of International Law / Law and Technologies) and social scientist (Özgün Erdener Topak, Associate Professor Coordinator of Criminology at York University) explore Israel's use of surveillance in carrying out the genocide. They argue "that Israel has constructed a Genocidal Surveillant Assemblage (GSA). The GSA combines various surveillance systems and sources – including data from intercepted communications and drone visuals, and harnesses the collected data with AI algorithms to generate targets for mass destruction."

****Khoury, Nadim. November 3, 2025. "The Meanings of a Second Nakba." *Journal of Genocide Research*, 1–16.** A Palestinian legal scholar (Department of Law, Philosophy, and International Studies Lillehammer, University of Inland Norway) explores the evolving meaning of "Nakba." He notes that "The widespread use of a second Nakba in Israeli politics is surprising, given the systematic denial of the first Nakba. The standard Israeli narrative holds Palestinians and neighbouring Arab states responsible for the fate of Palestinian refugees in 1948." Yet, "one should not underestimate the significance of Palestinians calling the genocide in Gaza a second Nakba. There has been a second intifada, a second, third, fourth, and fifth war on Gaza, but there has never been a second Nakba until now. Foundational pasts rarely occur twice. When they do, it is important to ask why and under what conditions."